



Organise functions

D1.HSM.CL5.01

D1.HCS.CL6.04

Trainee Manual



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Trainee Manual



William
Angliss
Institute

Specialist centre
for foods, tourism
& hospitality

Project Base

William Angliss Institute of TAFE
555 La Trobe Street
Melbourne 3000 Victoria
Telephone: (03) 9606 2111
Facsimile: (03) 9670 1330

Acknowledgements

Project Director:	Wayne Crosbie
Chief Writer:	Alan Hickman
Subject Writer:	Nick Hyland
Project Manager/Editor:	Alan Maguire
DTP/Production:	Daniel Chee, Mai Vu, Kaly Quach

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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees' chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service

- Front Office
- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Organise functions

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Organise functions in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D1.HSM.CL5.01
D1.HCS.CL6.04

Nominal Hours:

45 hours

Element 1: Identify function facilities and procedures at the host establishment

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Explain the role of the Functions Booking book
- 1.2 Identify the facilities available for functions
- 1.3 Identify the styles of functions that can be accommodated
- 1.4 Identify the styles of service available
- 1.5 Describe the function set-up options available
- 1.6 Describe the function menus available
- 1.7 Identify function costs for the customer
- 1.8 Develop a function kit
- 1.9 Identify the role of function-related documentation

Element 2: Liaise with function customers

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Determine customer needs
- 2.2 Identify date and time of function
- 2.3 Match establishment resources to identified need for function
- 2.4 Provide advice and assistance in relation to the function
- 2.5 Record function requirements as agreed by customer
- 2.6 Confirm function booking with customer
- 2.7 Obtain deposit for function

Element 3: Prepare for functions

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Maintain and update Function Sheet
- 3.2 Advise colleagues and staff in relation to function
- 3.3 Roster staff for function
- 3.4 Minimise impact of function on normal establishment operation
- 3.5 Arrange for external services as identified
- 3.6 Purchase necessary stock for function
- 3.7 Prepare Running Sheet for function
- 3.8 Conduct pre-function briefings
- 3.9 Finalise function details with customer, colleagues and staff
- 3.10 Monitor set-up for the function
- 3.11 Monitor service delivery of function

Element 4: Follow-up after functions

Performance Criteria

- 4.1 Obtain feedback from customer
- 4.2 Obtain payment for function
- 4.3 De-brief staff

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Identify function facilities and procedures at the host establishment				
1.1	Explain the role of the Functions Booking book	1.1	1	1
1.2	Identify the facilities available for functions	1.2	2	2
1.3	Identify the styles of functions that can be accommodated	1.3	3	3
1.4	Identify the styles of service available	1.4	4	4
1.5	Describe the function set-up options available	1.5	5	5
1.6	Describe the function menus available	1.6	6	6
1.7	Identify function costs for the customer	1.7	7	7
1.8	Develop a function kit	1.8	8	8
1.9	Identify the role of function-related documentation	1.9	9	9
Element 2: Liaise with function customers				
2.1	Determine customer needs	2.1	10	10
2.2	Identify date and time of function	2.2	11	11
2.3	Match establishment resources to identified need for function	2.3	12	12
2.4	Provide advice and assistance in relation to the function	2.4	13	13
2.5	Record function requirements as agreed by customer	2.5	14	14

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
2.6	Confirm function booking with customer	2.6	15	15
2.7	Obtain deposit for function	2.7	16	16
Element 3: Prepare for functions				
3.1	Maintain and update Function Sheet	3.1	17	17
3.2	Advise colleagues and staff in relation to function	3.2	18	18
3.3	Roster staff for function	3.3	19	19
3.4	Minimise impact of function on normal establishment operation	3.4	20	20
3.5	Arrange for external services as identified	3.5	21	21
3.6	Purchase necessary stock for function	3.6	22	22
3.7	Prepare Running Sheet for function	3.7	23	23
3.8	Conduct pre-function briefings	3.8	24	24
3.9	Finalise function details with customer, colleagues and staff	3.9	25	25
3.10	Monitor set-up for the function	3.10	26	26
3.11	Monitor set-up for the function	3.11	27	27
Element 4: Follow-up after functions				
4.1	Obtain feedback from customer	4.1	28	28
4.2	Obtain payment for function	4.2	29	29
4.3	De-brief staff	4.3	30	30

Glossary

Term	Explanation
Access	The right of entry to a venue
Accoutrements	'Accoutrements' are the items used to fit out the tables.
A la carte	Term used for a menu that has individually priced dishes
Banquet	A formal event comprising food, beverage and entertainment
Briefing	An informational meeting
Buffet	A display of food and beverage items
Catering	The provision of food, beverage and other services associated with an event, function or meeting
Continental breakfast	A style of breakfast made up of fruit, cereal, pastries, juices and tea and coffee. No cooked food is normally included
Cover	A place setting for one guest
Crockery	Plates, bowls, cups and saucers
Cutlery	Knives, forks, spoons and teaspoons
Deficiencies	Problems that exist in an operation, technique or equipment
Event / Function	A structured purpose for people meeting together
Glassware	Different types of glass vessels
Linen	Cloth items used in an outlet including napkins, tablecloths, service cloths and skirting
Sautéing	Where food is tossed in a small amount of hot fat over high heat to colour the food evenly during cooking
Suppliers	Different organisations that contribute to the running of an event or function

Element 1:

Identify function facilities and procedures at the host establishment

1.1 Explain the role of the Functions Booking book

Introduction

Functions are a unique style of service provided by hospitality organisations. Traditionally hospitality organisations were designed around the simple concept of providing accommodation, through the use of guest rooms, and food and beverage through a restaurant or bar.

However the role of functions has played an ever increasing role in hospitality organisations and is a major revenue source. Whilst some aspects of function service reflect those provided in restaurants and bars, the range of products and services provided in functions makes it very different indeed.

As most functions are unique and present many challenges, it is an exciting operation that requires creative, flexible and hard working individuals.



In today's world, where time is of the essence, anyone can take advantage of organisations that provide function services to organise any occasion, whether for business or pleasure. By using dedicated functions' providers a lot of the organisation, hassle, responsibility and stress associated with holding a function are taken away.

This manual will explore the world of functions and discuss all the activities associated in planning, preparing and delivering a range of functions.

Benefits of functions

There are many reasons why functions are becoming a popular style of business.

For the customer:

- It saves time and stress
- It allows for professional staff to have the responsibility for running a function
- It provides access to a venue, room size and equipment that is not found in a normal office or home environment
- The outcome is a product or service which cannot be produced by a home or office environment.



For a hospitality organisation

- It is a major revenue source
- It can appeal to a variety of market segments
- It allows the organisation to promote itself by showcasing unique functions and events
- It promotes creativity, skills and knowledge in staff.

Role of the Functions Booking Book

A functions booking book is the primary document that is used to record any tentative or confirmed functions that may be taking place in a hospitality establishment.

This book is the first place a functions manager will look when a potential customer enquires about a function.

It provides a summary of what functions are being held and a snapshot as to the type of function. The information normally recorded includes details of functions that have been booked by:

- Customer name and contact details
- Day, date and time
- Description of function
- Room/location to be used
- Approximate numbers attending.

The different types of functions will be explained in more detail throughout this manual.



1.2 Identify the facilities available for functions

Introduction

In most hotels there is a dedicated area for functions, which can cater to a wide variety of activities comprising each function.

The facilities normally comprise a number of empty rooms that can be used for a variety of purposes. In addition, they are designed with flexibility in mind to ensure that they meet the needs of each function. It is common for a function area to be made up of one large vacant area that can be divided into smaller individual rooms of different sizes.



Given that many function areas are extremely busy, it is also common for a wide range of hotel facilities to be used that are associated with functions.

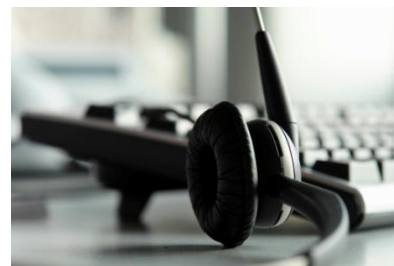
Range of facilities

The various hotel facilities that may be used to directly or indirectly support functions include:

- Meeting/conference room. This is the main facility that is used for a function. Many functions during the day hold business related meetings. The focus of these rooms is to ensure small to large meetings can be conducted with the appropriate technological capacity
- Stand up conference areas. This can include areas outside the main conference room that are used for welcoming customers, break out areas, cocktail receptions etc. These areas may not be as large as the main room themselves, however may offer great views and are a great area to use, when main conference room needs to be replenished or cleaned
- Banquet room. These rooms, often similar to meeting or conference rooms, are used for banquets. As will be discussed in the next section, a banquet is a function based around the provision of food and beverage. Therefore, not only does the room need to be large to accommodate weddings, but it needs direct access to a kitchen or bar dispensing facility
- Exhibition bays and space. Many hotels cater to the exhibition market where customers can showcase their offerings. These rooms need to be big and are able to accommodate separate bays and high displays
- Business centres are used to aid organisers and participants of events with all their business needs through a host of services including:
 - High-speed Internet access
 - Word processing
 - Photocopying



- Computer access and rental
 - Faxing services
 - Office supplies
 - Packaging and shipping
 - Secretarial services
 - Courier service
 - Translations
 - Arrangement of transport
- Auditoriums are used for large audience presentations and events. These areas must be able to accommodate large seating capacities and have adequate height and depth for main stages
 - Press rooms. These are used by the press in order to prepare and submit information relating to a function taking place in the hotel. They will normally include the provision of:
 - Tables and Chairs
 - Internet access
 - Business equipment
 - Basic food and beverage
 - Storage bays. These are used to store a wide range of items used for a function, whether for the use of staff or customers, and include:
 - Storage cupboards for packages, boxes, equipment, stationery, documents decorations and displays to be used in a function. Often these items are sent in advance of the function itself by the organiser
 - Cloak rooms for jackets and coats of participants
 - Baggage areas for luggage of participants. In some cases participants of functions may not have access to accommodation rooms and need a place to store luggage whilst the function commences. In addition presents for weddings may need to be stored for later collection
 - Parking facilities. Naturally, depending on the size of the function, suitable parking needs to be arranged. Spaces may need to be reserved for all participants or for a selected few VIPs
 - Change rooms may need to be provided for sporting events or where participants may need to refresh after a conference before departing the hotel
 - Display areas. These may be outside the main function room, enabling a company to place a banner or a display. Often it is immediately outside the main function room, the lift or in the lobby of the hotel



- Designated and discreet sections of restaurants and/or bars. These are normally used as dedicated lunch or dining areas for functions. In cases where main function rooms are operating at maximum capacity, these may be used as function rooms themselves. They will be partitioned off to ensure privacy. Quite often they are used for staff meetings and training sessions
- Food and beverage service. Many functions have some element of food and beverage which require preparation kitchens and fridges etc.
- Accommodation rooms may be used for a number of reasons including:
 - To accommodate participants overnight
 - To be used as breakout rooms to host smaller meetings
 - To be used as a rest and change area for wedding parties and for VIPs at conferences. It is not uncommon for a hotel to allocate a number of rooms to a large functions enabling VIPs to refresh before departing for long flights
- Sound and lighting. Not only does sound and equipment take up a large amount of space, any parts must also be stored in a safe and secure location.
- Communication technologies and equipment. In most events or functions, there is a need for some need for technical equipment or services including:
 - Audio which can include taping, telephone hook-ups, speakers to external points
 - Visual (video/television/direct conference)
 - Data projectors
 - Large screens including printable white boards
 - Multimedia provision including linkages and compatible hook-up points
 - Computers and internet connectivity
- Sound and music facilities, including microphones, speakers etc
- Gardens. These are often used for outdoor events such as cocktail parties and weddings.



1.3 Identify the styles of functions that can be accommodated

Introduction

Most people may think that a function is just a catered event where people sit down to a banquet dinner. It could not be further from the truth.

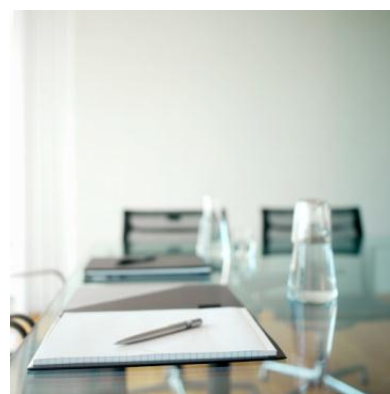
There are endless styles of functions that can be arranged, tailored to the unique specifications and requirements of the customer.

Therefore the activities to be conducted will vary depending on the event of function that is taking place.

Styles of functions

The hospitality industry can deliver a range of different function styles for customers including:

- Breakfasts
- Lunches
- Dinners
- Seminars, workshops and conferences
- Cocktail parties
- General parties – birthdays, celebrations of various sorts
- Weddings/receptions
- Anniversaries
- 21st birthday parties
- Product launches and distributor functions
- School formal, annual dinners and dinner dances
- Annual general meetings
- Training seminars
- Graduations and award nights
- Press receptions
- Fashion shows
- Special events
- Tradeshows
- Stage productions, including music events.



As you can see, the styles of functions are endless. Whilst many hospitality organisations may offer all of these to potential customers, they may also specialise in order to attract a select or niche market and be seen as the industry leaders for a particular style of function.

MICE

Many venues focus on the MICE sector of the industry.

MICE stands for Meetings, Incentives, Conferences and Events.

- Meetings include general business meetings
- Incentives refers to functions that businesses organise to reward or motivate staff
- Conferences are usually business/industry based occasions where people get together to discuss issues and share knowledge
- Events can include bands, concerts and a variety of entertainments.



1.4 Identify the styles of service available

Introduction

As can be seen in the last section there are endless types of functions that can be arranged. To meet the versatility of these functions, it is important to have versatility in the way food and beverage is served (known as styles of service) and menu options available.

This section will explore the different styles of service that can be used to meet the needs of different styles of functions.

Formality of functions

Functions may range from informal through to formal to reflect the nature of the function.

Informal functions

Informal functions are characterised by:

- No set time for guest arrival
- No dress code
- Flexible times for food and beverage service
- Impromptu speeches
- No service protocol
- No seating plan.



Formal functions

Formal functions are characterised by:

- Dress code
- Set time for guests to arrive
- Registration and name tag requirements
- Allocated time for speeches and presentations

- Specific meal times
- Semi-silver service or full silver service
- Program for the occasion
- Specific service protocols
- Specific seating plan
- Guest speakers or Master of Ceremonies presentation
- Specific times for entertainment to commence and finish.



Styles of service

Plated service

Plated service is the most common service style where the kitchen plates all the food and the waiting staff carry the plated food to the table.

This is a common style of service for most banquets.

The benefits of plated service are:

- Consistency of meals
- Fast service - as meals are plated in the kitchen and then delivered quickly to the customer
- Portion control – chefs have a degree of control over portion sizes.



Silver service

Silver service is where food items are prepared and carved or separated into individual portions and placed on platters by kitchen staff. Then waiting staff use spoons and forks to serve food from service platters, and serve sauces to guests on an individual basis from a sauce boat.

Whilst this style of service is not common in many functions due to its labour and time intensive manner, it is most commonly used when serving bread rolls to the customers.

The benefits of silver service are:

- Adds a dimension of 'entertainment and sophistication'
- Customers can choose what they like without leaving the table.

Semi-silver service

Semi-silver service is where the meals are plated and the sauces are 'silver served' or where the meat component of the dish is plated and served, and the vegetables are silver served

The benefits of semi-silver service are:

- Increases options for customer
- A more time efficient use of silver service.



Gueridon service

This is where food is prepared or cooked at the table and served using full silver service techniques. This service style is not common for large banquets and in fact is only suited to intimate situations, whether catering to high end clients or for special occasions such as romantic meals.

The benefits of gueridon service are:

- It is a form of entertainment
- It is interactive
- It allows customers to see the cooking process
- Meals can be prepared to customer's exact specifications.

Buffet service

This is where food is prepared in kitchens in large quantities and then placed on a buffet or display table. In most buffet situations guests serve themselves and select the items and quantities they desire.

In some situations a staffed buffet may be offered. In this scenario, diners bring their own plate along the buffet line and are given a portion from a server at each station. This method is prevalent at catered meetings where diners are not paying specifically for their meal in an effort to reduce wastage and to have some form of portion control.

The focus of staff in this situation is to:

- Replenish food items
- Keep buffet areas clean
- Provide crockery and cutlery
- Clear the tables.

The benefits of buffet service are:

- Customers have greater choice
- They can have small amounts of different items as opposed to having one type of food
- Service is very time efficient
- Labour demands are reduced
- Food can be prepared in advance.



Cocktail service

This style of service is very popular, either as a prelude to a dinner or as a standalone function in its own right. In essence this style of service involves waiters providing a range of finger foods and beverages to customers in a stand up function.

The benefits of cocktail service are:

- It has great flexibility in terms of both cost and item options
- It is a cost effective method for clients to provide food and beverage to their participants
- It can be performed within a limited time frame
- It requires only a small space
- Participants can mingle with each other easily.

1.5 Describe the function set-up options available

Introduction

A function set up will vary depending on the purpose, style of function and style of service. These have been identified in the previous sections of this manual.

There are a number of set up options, also known as room layouts that can be used to meet the requirements of each type of function.

Function set up options

Room layout will depend on customer needs and the style best suited to meet those needs.

Stand-up function

This style of function is generally used for cocktail parties, general parties or lunches that are part of a conference.

The only seating might be around the edges of the room with several tables placed randomly in various places to provide the guests with a place to put down their drinks and any unwanted glassware, plates, food scraps.

When deciding if a stand-up function is suitable, it is worth bearing in mind the proposed duration of the function. Does the client think that the guests can stand for the length of time expected?

Stand-up lunches for conferences where delegates have been seated all morning are a good idea to allow them to stand up for a while.

Stand-up lunches are usually less expensive than sit-down meals and they encourage people to mingle and network.

The very nature of a stand-up function is attractive to some clients and to some function types as it does not encourage people to settle in and stay for extended periods.

Sit down function

This style of function is generally used for weddings or formal dinners, banquets and presentations.

Most dinners for conferences are also sit-down.

The tables and seating used for such a function are placed in accordance with specific table number and stated seating requirements.



Some functions may require tables of six, whereas other functions may require tables of ten or more.

Boardroom meeting

Smaller functions or meetings can be catered for in small rooms or the board room.

There are a number of styles to use when setting up a boardroom meeting.

Each style has its own benefits, which should be matched to the needs of the client.

- Theatre style. This is where chairs are placed in rows facing a stage or head table. This layout is used to address large audiences who do not need tables in which to record information. It is also used where the audience is required to listen as opposed to communicating themselves. It is important to have aisles in which both participants and speakers can easily move around. It is popular with seminars and presentations
- Boardroom style. This is the use of a small to large table where all participants are able to see and converse with each other and have their own place in which to spread out documents and record information. This layout is popular for many meetings as it allows for interaction
- Hollow Square. Depending on the size of the audience, a boardroom format may be required, to allow for interaction and discussion but there are simply too many people. In essence this is where tables are set up in a square, hexagon or round format with room for microphones, photographers or plant displays in the middle
- Classroom style. This is where tables and chairs are set up in straight lines or in a v-shape formation, similar to a classroom setting at school. The tables face the front of the room so that all participants can easily see the instructor. This layout is popular when large amounts of audience members are in attendance, each requiring space to lay out documents. It is also useful in presenting computer training sessions
- Banquet style. This is where smaller round, square or rectangular tables are used for smaller discussions and group work
- U Shape. Also known as a 'horseshoe', this format allows audience members to see each other and interact whilst accommodating larger numbers. It also allows for a presenter to walk within the 'U-shape' itself to personally interact with each participant. It is a very popular layout method
- E-shape. This is a variation to a U 'shape' as it allows for greater numbers of audience members, as table is placed in the middle of the U 'shape'.



Using different set up options

Depending on the function they may use different lay outs, either:

- Simultaneously. This is where a function may address large audiences. It therefore requires a seminar format, but then allows participants to work in smaller groups, using a boardroom or banquet style
- At different times of the day. For example a room may be set up for a conference using a 'U-shape- format during the day but need a banquet layout at night for a formal dinner.

1.6 Describe the function menus available

Introduction

In Sections 1.3 and 1.4 of this manual, a range of functions were identified, aimed at the provision of food and beverage. This section will explore common function menus that are available. Naturally each organisation will have their own types and variations of menus to reflect the local environment and culture and the requirements of the client.

Menu considerations

Most organisations will have a varied selection of different menu options taking into consideration:

- Styles of functions – whether food and beverage is a main aspect of the function (such as a banquet) or to supplement a function (such as a coffee break during a meeting)
- Styles of service required – as identified in Section 1.4 including plated service, silver service, semi-plated service, stand-up finger food, buffet, a la carte, table d'hôte or set menu options
- Timing of functions. Depending on the time available for the consumption of food and beverage, some options may be more appropriate than others
- Providing a variety of price points. This is important so that the client can choose a specific price point and quality of food and beverage offering to meet their needs and budgets
- Having inclusive and non-inclusive menus. Depending on the participants some clients may wish to have a one price option which covers everything or is happy to pay for each item consumed. These options will be discussed in more detail later in this section.



Types of food and beverage menus

The types and styles of food and beverage menus will vary greatly depending on the size and style of the venue, available budget, client preferences, nature of the function and various timing factors such as time of day, day of the week, time of the year, pre and post function activities.

It is important to price all menus shown to guests with flexibility. That is, with a range of pricing options designed to meet the needs of a diversity of potential clients.

Options in relation to pricing include substitution of dishes, elimination or addition of courses, incorporation of beverages with meals, and service style options (silver service compared with table service).

The following are some typical examples of the types of menus used for function service and demonstrate the options that are available within what may seem fairly basic meal times.

Breakfast menu

- Continental
- Continental plus selected cooked food items
- Continental plus full cooked food items
- Food platters – fruit and bakery items, intended as finger food
- Beverage items – coffee, tea, juices
- Buffet breakfast for large numbers
- Full breakfast – cereal, juices, cooked main items, toast, tea and coffee: served to seated guests.



Morning/afternoon teas

- Selection of pastries and bakery items
- Selection of open or closed sandwiches
- Selection of biscuits and cake
- Selection of petit fours
- Beverage items – coffee, tea, juice, water, aerated waters.



Lunch menu

- Buffet of selected hot and cold items. This may include an entrée, main course and dessert, or any combination
- Set menu (to a specific number of courses) and can be served to seated guests or presented for buffet style service
- Platters of sandwiches, filled rolls. Sandwiches and rolls may be open or closed
- Platters of cakes, biscuits, pastries and petit fours
- Platters of fruit, fruit and cheese, cheese and greens
- Beverages. A selection of alcoholic and non-alcoholic beverages which may include full bar, selected and minimal liquor, or non-alcoholic beverages only comprising aerated waters, waters, fruit juices, mocktails.



Dinner

Dinners are traditionally 'heavier' meals than lunches. This is because guests are not going to be doing anything after dinner, whereas with lunch there may be a need for guests to pay attention and not nod off to sleep!

One common difference is that platters are not usual at dinners. However there is a section of the market emerging that seems to prefer finger food dinners. This may be driven by economic imperatives.

- Set menu (to a specific number of courses). This can be served to seated guests or presented for buffet style service. Dinners are more commonly a seated affair where lunches tend to be buffet style
- Buffet of selected hot and cold items. This may include an entrée, main course and dessert, or any combination. More time is traditionally available for dinners whereas with lunches there tends to be a tighter time frame as people need to return to meetings, groups or activities by a given time
- Beverages. There may be a selection of alcoholic and non-alcoholic beverages. There may be a set number of specific wines set on each table. Above that, guests may be required to pay for what they want, or there may be a full bar facility.



Seminar/conference

- This usually involves a selection of light refreshments - small sandwiches and rolls etc compared to substantial menu items. The idea is not to send the people off to sleep. There is a definite need to include healthy options such as fruit
- Commonly these meals are buffet style or finger food style to keep costs down, and to facilitate the concept of people networking at the function
- Morning and afternoon teas are common with pastries, cakes and biscuits rotating throughout the time of the conference
- Beverages. Alcohol is less common, but not unknown; non-alcoholic beverages include tea and coffee, and water
- Tea, coffee, water and pastries may be served to guests on arrival in the morning while people are arriving, registering and mingling.



Wedding

- Commonly a set menu specifying the number of courses to be served, and the style to be used
- Can also feature a buffet of hot and cold food items
- Beverages may be a nominated selection of alcoholic and non-alcoholic beverages, full bar, or guests pay as they go.



Cocktail parties

- Platters of hors d'oeuvre and canapés can be presented in a buffet style, or served by waiting staff
- Beverages are usually a nominated selection of alcoholic and non-alcoholic beverages up to a set dollar figure, or for a given time period.



Promotions and product launches

- Generally features a selection of light refreshments – small sandwiches, rolls, canapés, and other finger food
- There may be a special room to cater for media attendees – reporters, photographers, audio/visual technicians
- Beverages may be dictated by the nature of the promotion or product being launched, but it is common for a nominated selection of alcoholic and non-alcoholic beverages to be present for the entire duration of the function.

Client providing own items

It is not uncommon for the customer to bring some of their own items to suit the requirements of the occasion. For birthdays and weddings it is normal for the customer to bring their own:

- Cakes
- Speciality wines
- Decorations.



Types of packages

As can be seen above there are many different types of menu options that are available to customers.

To keep it simple, functions present three common package options:

Inclusive packages

- This is where an all-up price is quoted to the host for the function and the price includes nominated food and beverages. The host pays this agreed amount regardless of whether the agreed number of guests attend or not, and regardless of how much of the agreed food and beverages are consumed. Any extras are paid for 'on consumption'
- It includes a set, negotiated range of drinks but does not stipulate quantities. Guests may drink as much as they like from, for example, bulk beer, house wines, soft drink and nominated pour brands of spirits. Anything apart from this, individuals pay for their own. This commonly refers to premium or more expensive brands.



Open bar

An open bar is where the guests at the function can order drinks without paying for them. The client settles the account at the end.

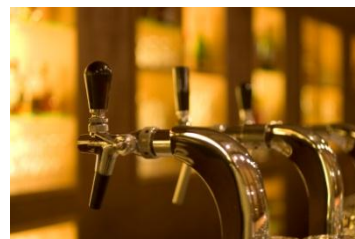
Open bars may be 'full bar' meaning there is no restriction at all as to what guests can order. They can order wine, spirits, beer, mixed drinks, any type, any brand. If the bar has the beverage, the guest can have it.

Open bars can also be 'restricted' meaning the drinks served to guests may be restricted to only draught beer, house wines and soft drink. If the guests want something other than these drinks they have to pay for it themselves.

Many hosts set a limit on the amount of money they are prepared to spend on an 'open bar'.

For example, the client may state they want a full open bar up to a limit of \$2,000.

Where this is the case it is standard practice to inform the client on the day of the function regarding the progress of this amount. In the case of the \$2,000 limit you might inform the client when \$1,000 has been reached, when \$1,500 has been reached, when \$1,750 has been reached.



Doing this allows the client to monitor consumption and provides them with an opportunity to authorise extra money to be allocated to the original \$2,000.

On-consumption basis

- Only what is consumed is charged for
- Client usually sets a limit above which guests pay for their own, however they sometimes extend the limit at the function. Below this limit it may be a case of:
 - Anything goes – guests can order bottles of wine, cocktails, premium spirits
 - Guests select only from a limited range of bulk beer, house wines, soft drink and nominated pour brands of spirits
 - A 'dry till' is run – that is, amounts are rung up on a cash register as drinks are served but no money changes hands.



Cash basis

This is a growing option as this style of service reduces the expense incurred by the host.

Cash bars are common. Guests pay for all their own drinks either obtaining them at the bar or via waiter service.

Tailoring menus to client needs

Regardless of the menu option selected by the client, it is important that a functions operation is flexible in ensuring that what can be provided meets their specifications.

This is important especially in relation to any dietary or cultural requirements which they may have.

1.7 Identify function costs for the customer

Introduction

There are a number of costs that are associated with a function. In later sections of this manual, the method and processes used in determining costs and presenting them to the client will be explained.

But firstly it is important to identify and understand the types of costs associated with a function.

Types of function costs

Whilst there is an endless amount of expense items that can be associated with a function, there are a number of standard categories in which these expenses will commonly fall under. These include:

- Room and facility hire. This is normally the standard expenses with any function, ranging from a set rate for a day or rented on an hourly basis. This expense is normally included in large package deals such as a 'meeting package'
- Food and beverage including 'on arrival' and during function as well as refreshments
- Decorations – basic items such as candles and flowers through to elaborate themes
- Specialist staff as required depending on the nature of the function including translators, technical IT and lighting experts and security
- Bands and entertainers. These are quite common at events such as weddings and parties
- Accommodation – discounted rates are normally provided to large functions
- Special requests. These could be endless to suit the needs of each function.



1.8 Develop a function kit

Introduction

Many establishments have a 'Function Kit' to assist in providing advice to clients, and to demonstrate the venue's expertise and ability in relation to events and functions.

By establishing a function kit clients have all the necessary options and information at their disposal which helps them to decide on the best options to suit their needs.

Whilst the development of a function kit does take some time to initially prepare, it will certainly save time for functions staff as they won't have to answer the same questions over and over again.

In addition, it will ensure that all necessary and relevant information is compiled in one handy and easy to use professional looking package.



Contents of a function kit

In essence the function kit will contain all the necessary information that a client may need to know.

These kits are given to the client to take away with them so they have printed information in relation to items such as:

- Details and information in relation to venue size, capacity of rooms and rooms/areas available
- Details and information in relation to alternative seating/table arrangement
- Venue facilities, services and equipment, including a range of items that can be hired for specific functions
- Sample menus for various dining styles, and at a range of price points
- Sample drink lists featuring alcoholic and non-alcoholic drinks by the bottle and by the glass
- Suggested staffing levels for functions of various numbers, and of various styles and types
- Colour photographs of different room set-ups and functions in progress. Most kits incorporate colour photographs of room and table set ups, as well as 'during the function' shots depicting what the 'final product' will look like
- Contact details of the venue
- A DVD of the venue with a focus on functions. These DVDs are loaned or given to prospective clients to watch in their own time.



Remember some customers booking a function may have used your establishment before, perhaps to hold another function, or perhaps just as a diner, guest or patron and therefore they may know something of the services and facilities on offer and will need little assistance in understanding what the venue can provide.

However, for other clients this may be the first time they have planned a function and will need assistance to ensure all aspects of the event are going to be catered for.

1.9 Identify the role of function-related documentation

Introduction

There is a vast amount of documentation that is used in the planning and coordination of functions. Some of these have and will be identified throughout this manual.

Although much communication relating to functions may be verbal, it is still necessary that all functions demand written information to give certainty and details about what is required.

This written documentation is used by many different stakeholders in a function.



Documentation for different stakeholders

Information for internal staff

Any documentation that is contained in the function file may be shared with internal staff, especially departmental managers such as head chefs, head housekeeper, food and beverage managers.

A vital document used to disseminate information is the function sheet. This should be distributed to all internal staff involved in the execution of the function.

Using a function sheet helps to ensure that everyone gets the same information. This reduces potential misunderstandings, keeps everyone heading in the same direction and indicates the planning that has gone into the function.

Suppliers

Documentation provided to suppliers will be limited to purchase orders for goods and services being supplied and a version of the running sheet to give them relevant dates, times and locations.

It is to be expected this written information will be supplemented by and clarified with verbal information as well.

The client

The information that is supplied to the client should include:

- Running sheet
- Function sheet
- Quotations from third party providers where the venue is arranging products and services on behalf of the client
- Samples of all materials agreed to as part of the agreement. This may include invitations, food menus, wine lists, drink lists, service vouchers etc.



Remember the client may receive several versions of some of the above as details of the function change during the planning phase.

A copy of everything provided to the client must be placed in the function file ensuring it carries a date to assist with version control.

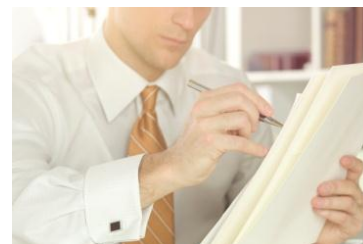
Maintain other relevant documents

As can be seen to date, functions and events generate loads of paperwork.

As mentioned, some of this documentation is for the client, some is for suppliers and much of it is for internal consumption.

The use of pro forma documents

Most venues that deal regularly with functions have generated their own documentation that has evolved over time to address and cater for what they have identified as being the necessary requirements of any event.



Some documentation is associated with function planning or management software but it is common that, where this facility exists, many venues still default to using their own 'purpose-built' documents.

Types of documents

We have already identified some common function documents. However more may be necessary.

Access and security details

Where the client or their personnel require access to the venue, rooms or facilities this list will identify:

- Dates and times involved
- Locations, rooms, facilities etc. to which access is sought
- Names of those nominated by the client as authorised to access the venue. In practice, no-one should be given access to the venue unless their name is on this list
- Registration numbers of vehicles
- The jobs they will be doing for the function.

Note that it is standard practice for security staff to have the right to search vehicles and personnel leaving the venue area.

It may be standard procedure for anyone accessing the venue who is not a staff member to be allocated a 'visitor' identification tag. This may identify the areas within the venue to which the holder has authority to enter.

Where the client has provided strict directions about who may enter a function/event the details on this list can include:

- Names of those who are authorised to enter. This may be accompanied by photo ID
- Names of those specifically identified as not being authorised to enter. This can occur when the client believes the function is likely to be targeted by a person or group who could disrupt or pose a threat to the occasion. There will usually be a photograph of these people with a brief outline regarding what type and level of threat they pose.

Access and security details can also cover:

- Establishment of communication and command centres for large functions
- Provision of suitable communication devices to security staff and, where appropriate, staff representing the client
- Allocation of other equipment (batons, handcuffs, mobile phones) as appropriate for the function
- Determination of controls to apply at access and egress points – ID checks, assigning wrist bands, cards and lanyards to indicate authority access for different people
- Identification of routes for foot patrols, and crowd control and surveillance points
- Allocation of temporary codes to enable access to visitors to coded security areas
- Observation of activities by all preparation staff, internal and external, during set-up and during take-down to deter theft.



Financial and Operations documents

Normal business practice should apply in the development of financial and operations records regarding a function.

This means the following will need to be arranged, as appropriate, at various times:

- Customer accounts
- Quotations
- Purchase orders
- Invoices to the client
- Statements for the client
- Receipts
- Post function reports
- Staff time sheets
- Function confirmation forms/letters
- Customer feedback form.

Service vouchers

Service vouchers are internal vouchers prepared by the venue for distribution to guests, delegates or attendees at a function.

The service vouchers entitle the holder to the products or services as listed on the voucher and as arranged with the client to be part of the function, free of charge.

For example, guests who are staying in-house may be entitled to a free breakfast or a service voucher may be issued to all such guests. When they arrive at the dining room for breakfast they hand over their voucher and it takes the form of legitimate payment.



Service vouchers may be issued for almost any product or service the venue supplies, providing it has been arranged with and paid for by the client. Examples of the use of service vouchers include:

- Free meals
- Free drinks at the bar
- Free use of facilities
- Free spa treatment
- Free tours/trips.

Information packs

The term 'information pack' in relation to functions can mean different things to different people.

Not all venues have information packs, but when they do they can be one of five types:

- A venue-specific information pack which only contains information about the venue itself. It might have a layout of the property, sample food menus and drink lists, history of the venue, internal telephone numbers, a voucher for a free drink, a pen or cap
- A venue-specific information pack containing information from the client. This pack contains information about the venue itself plus whatever information the client wants to add. This may include leaflets, brochures, giveaways, merchandise, guest list, event schedules
- A client specific information pack where the contents are solely as determined by the client
- A local information pack containing details of the local tourist attractions, natural attractions and shopping precincts
- A pack that includes venue information, client information and local information.

Information packs can be:

- Provided on tables for attendees to help themselves to
- Left in guest rooms
- Handed out in-person when delegates register.

These information packs can also provide the medium for distributing:

- Service vouchers
- Name tags and lanyards
- Conference materials such as compendiums, satchels, literature, stationery.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 1.1 Research and identify the purpose, role and inclusions of a Functions Booking book
 - 1.2 Research and identify the range of facilities that are available for functions
 - 1.3. Research and identify the different styles of functions
 - 1.4. Research and identify different styles of service used in a function
 - 1.5 Research and identify different types of function set up options
 - 1.6 Research and identify function menus available, including:
 - Menu considerations
 - Types of food and beverage menus
 - Types of packages.
 - 1.7 Research and identify different types of function costs
 - 1.8 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify the contents of a function kit
 - 1.9 Research and identify the different types of function-related documentation
-

Summary

Identify function facilities and procedures at the host establishment

Explain the role of the Functions Booking book

- Benefits of functions
- Role of the Functions Booking Book.

Identify the facilities available for functions

- Range of facilities.

Identify the styles of functions that can be accommodated

- Styles of functions.

Identify the styles of service available

- Formality of functions
- Styles of service.

Describe the function set-up options available

- Function set up options
- Using different set up options.

Describe the function menus available

- Menu considerations
- Types of food and beverage menus
- Types of packages
- Tailoring menus to client needs.

Identify function costs for the customer

- Types of function costs.

Develop a function kit

- Contents of a function kit.

Identify the role of function-related documentation

- Documentation for different stakeholders
- Maintain other relevant documents.

Element 2:

Liaise with function customers

2.1 Determine customer needs

Introduction

Before any event or function can be organised you need to first determine client needs.

The most effective way to do this is to meet face to face with the client and talk to them about their needs, wants and preferences.

Meeting with the client

After receiving an enquiry regarding an event or function it is best practice to invite the client to your venue to:

- Talk to them about their expectations and needs
- Allow them to view the property and its facilities
- Meet some of the key staff, where appropriate.



The meeting should be scheduled at a time to suit the client and conducted in a private location, such as the boardroom or your office.

It is appropriate to provide catering, light refreshments and even a meal.

It is important to identify client requirements in order to determine whether or not the venue can, or wants to, provide what is required.

The following is a list of the customer needs that need to be addressed as part of this process. Your venue may have a checklist prepared to guide you through the questions to ask and the information to be gathered at this initial meeting. Where you have such a checklist you must use it.

If you do not have such a checklist it is vital you take extensive notes to function as the basis for the work you will need to do in order to provide costings, suggestions, options and ideas to the client.

Understanding customer needs

Customer needs may include:

- A specific day and date
- Style and format of function
- Location – including interior and exterior requirements, and nominated rooms/areas
- Timing and duration considerations including access times for customer to prepare and set up as they wish, arrival times for guests, service times, speeches and presentations, cessation of service, guest departure

- Food and beverages, accommodation and entertainment
- Specialist technology services
- Ancillary services and rooms including security, technical staff, and translators
- Guest numbers
- Privacy
- Budget.



These needs will be explained in more detail in the next sections of the manual.

2.2 Identify date and time of function

Introduction

Naturally, before any other information is discussed, it is important to identify the desired date and time of the function. Once these have been identified other customer needs can also be addressed.

Timing

As mentioned, this is probably the first thing to be discussed.

You need to identify the date the client wants their function and the time of day their function will occupy.

Most clients will have a specific date in mind and a start and finish time. In the majority of cases this is not negotiable. If you are already booked for this date the client will often have to look elsewhere. In some limited cases the client will have room to move the function.

You need to identify:

- Date of the event or function. Remember some functions such as conferences and incentives will take more than one day
- The amount of preparation time needed to set up rooms and otherwise get the function area ready for the event. This may include use of in-house staff and external suppliers to set up stages, lighting and displays
- Checking availability in Functions Booking book
- Assessing the potential for moving existing bookings to a different location and/or date.

Most venues have a function booking book in paper-based or electronic format. You should have this with you at the meeting to assist in identifying availability and options.

Note that further details regarding timing requirements will need to be addressed at a later stage when the function is confirmed.



Type of function

You need to identify the type of function the client wants to hold.

This is important as some venues have a policy of not hosting certain events such as rowdy parties or sporting groups.

Knowing about the type of function may also intersect with availability issues. For example, you may be able to host a small function for 20 people in a small function room at the same time a larger function is taking place in the main function room.

Size and type of room

One of the most important aspects of a function is the requirements for where the function is to take place and how much room is needed.

Questions that may be asked include:

- What room requirements do they need?
- Do they have a preference for your ballroom, dining room, foyer, outside area, small conference room or theatrette?
- Is there a need for break-out rooms?



Numbers attending

This is another critical requirement as all venues have limits on the numbers of people they can accommodate.

Once again, this factor also intersects with potential room availability.

Some venues will also seek to identify the ratio of males to females attending, as well as number of children. In a conference situation there may also be accompanying delegates not attending the conference.



Catering

At this stage discussions regarding catering need only to address general requirements.

Catering refers to the provision of food and beverages for the function.

You should attempt to determine answers to the following questions:

- If the enquiry is about a function:
 - Is catering required 'on arrival'? If so, what is required?
 - Does the client want a sit-down meal or stand-up finger food?
 - If it is a sit-down meal, how many courses?
 - If it is finger food, what sort of food is required?
 - Are there any special requests, or needs to accommodate any special health or cultural requirements?



- If the enquiry is about an event:
 - Is catering required 'on arrival'? If so, what is required?
 - Is there a requirement to provide catering at break times – morning tea, afternoon tea, supper? If so, what is required? Danish pastries, cake, biscuits, fruit?
 - Is there any requirement to provide refreshments throughout the day for the event? This may include mints, bottled water, jugs of water, fruit juices etc
 - Is catering required for breakfast, lunch or dinner?
 - Does the client want a sit-down meal or stand-up finger food for lunch?
 - If it is a sit-down meal, how many courses?
 - If it is finger food, what sort of food is required?
 - Are there any special requests, or needs to accommodate any special health or cultural requirements?



Technical equipment

The technical requirements for a function will vary greatly depending on the type and style of function being booked.

Not all establishments will have technical equipment on-hand and may need to lease or hire such equipment from an outside service.

The cost of this will be charged to the customer.

The different types of technical equipment were previously discussed.

Some clients, especially companies, will want to use their own audio-visual people and equipment for the screening of DVDs, PowerPoint presentations slides, the presentation of speeches, recording of events, or management of teleconferences.



It is important to get a clear understanding of what is required in this regard as your costings will need to include the cost of any equipment that has to be hired or bought for the function.

Access

It is important to raise access to the property as part of the initial discussion to identify what the client requirements are likely to be prior to the event.

Many clients require access to the venue or function area to deliver materials, goods, and displays and to enable their personnel to assist with setting up displays, setting sound and lighting levels, testing equipment, placing flowers on tables etc.

In some cases their needs can be quite extensive and in other cases there is no need for access other than at the time of the function.

This topic relates strongly to bump-in and bump-out.

When you discuss access it is useful to also cover a description of what the client wants to bring in to the venue. For example, the client may want to have a car as part of a display but your facility may not enable access to something of that size.

Bump-in and bump-out

Bump-in and bump-out is commonly called just called 'bump-in, bump-out'.

It is most commonly used when bands are involved but can also apply to other events.

It refers to the time and dates that the client has to move their items into the venue (bump-in) and for removing them from the venue after the event has finished (bump-out).

It is important client requirements in this regard are factored in when determining availability of the venue.

Generally, the larger the function, the more time required for bump-in, bump-out. One to two days is not uncommon.

You also need to realise the bump-in, bump out times can also add expense to the costing as there will need to be someone from the venue available to answer questions, provide directions and oversee activities during these periods.

Themes and decorations

It is quite common for functions to involve a theme and the use of decorations to match the theme or to add to the visual appeal of the event.

From time to time you may be asked to suggest a theme for a function, and to suggest decorations.

It is best to ask the client if they have any thoughts on the matter before making these suggestions as they are fraught with danger since your recommendations can often not align with client preferences.

Where possible refer the client to photographs or DVDs of previous functions.

Questions that may be asked include:

- Is there to be any theme or special decorations required?
- Is the client supplying them and putting them up?
- Does the client want the venue to supply them?
- What sort do they want and how extensive are they?



Security

You should also ask the client about their requirements for security.

While the venue may provide a basic security service for small functions, larger functions can create a need for extra security staff, which will have to be charged for.

Security staff may, depending on the function, be required to:

- Provide screening of people entering the function
- Provide general crowd control
- Secure car parks
- Patrol the areas 'out of hours' – this is most common where displays or marquees are set up in external areas.



Media

It is always worthwhile raising the issue of media attention at any function and identifying how the client wants them treated.

Clients often forget about media attendance.

In many cases the client can require them to receive specified catering, access etc.

Use of external suppliers

There are a wide variety of external suppliers that can be used to help provide or assist in the running and coordination of an event.

The different types of external suppliers will be identified in Section 3.5 of this manual.

Other possible needs

Every function will be unique and different in its own way. It is essential that any special customer needs are identified. In some cases the needs may not be able to be met, either due to capacity, ability to perform, government restrictions, house policy or it may impact greatly on other functions taking place at the same time.

Where possible though, it is important to help and provide assistance in meeting any customer needs.

Conducting research

The nature of functions can be that clients are looking for 'something new' or 'something different' for their function. Whether as a response to a potential customer or as a professional development exercise, it is always advantageous to explore new concepts and ideas that can be integrated into current operations.

This places an obligation on you to keep abreast of changes in the wider marketplace regarding facilities and inclusions that may be used by your venue.



Researching information

The standard ways to maintain awareness of new ideas and items that could be of use are:

- Networking with others. This can include forming a business relationship with other venues that offer functions and talking to them about what they are doing or initiatives they are aware of
- Talking to suppliers – especially those who are in the functions sector – and can be expected to provide equipment to support these occasions. Personally visiting suppliers is also worthwhile
- Doing online research to view the items available from suppliers and search ‘events and functions’ to identify new sites and ideas
- Attending functions. You should strive to attend as many as you can to pick up ideas
- Subscribing to industry publications including:
 - www.specialevents.com
 - www.event-solutions.com
 - www.successfulmeetings.com
 - www.eventmagazine.co.uk

2.3 Match establishment resources to identified need for function

Introduction

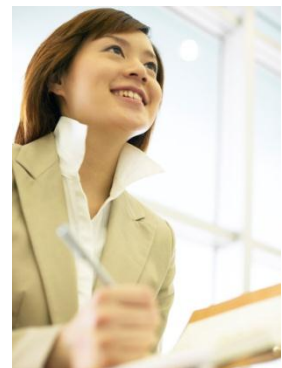
Once all the customer's needs have been identified, it is important to try to demonstrate how these needs can be met.

One of the key purposes of this initial meeting, along with both parties becoming acquainted with each other, is for the function staff to be able to successfully demonstrate that they can professionally and competently cater to the customer's needs.

They must install confidence in the customer that they are the right organisation to handle their function. This is very important, as whilst hospitality organisations may undertake functions on a daily basis, in the eyes of the customer, their function may mark a very special event in their professional or personal lives, and they must feel comfortable and confident that they choose the right ‘partner’ who can deliver what they are asking.

It is expected that the customer will be visiting more than one hospitality venue, and therefore you must be able to demonstrate and explain why your organisation is the best choice.

There are a number of ways function staff can help to demonstrate they have the capacity to handle customer requirements.



Describing function facilities and options available

Firstly, one of the key steps is to explain the different product and service options available to meet their needs. Their explanation must be tailored to matching the customer needs.

Quite often a staff member may show a photo collection of what has been done in the past or what is possible. Many clients can gain a better understanding through visual explanations.

Giving Function Kit to customer and explaining the contents

As identified in Section 1.8 of this manual, a function kit provides comprehensive information on what the organisation can provide.

It is important to remember that the kit will contain large amounts of information about the overall offering, some of which will not be relevant to the customer.

Therefore it is essential to:

- Identify sections such as pictures, menus etc. that are relevant to the client
- Providing an explanation of each item or topic
- Removing information that is not relevant.

The customer will have a good look at the actual information at a later stage, so for now it is important to get across the key messages about what can be offered so that the customer can get an overall picture.

Providing guided tour of premises and facilities to customer

It is standard practice to include a tour of the venue as part of the first meeting with the client.

The tour should include a visit to all areas of the property that will be involved in the function. For example, if the event requires accommodation, then the rooms of the property should be included in the tour.

In some cases you may need to schedule a second meeting with the client in order to conduct this tour as the client may wish to have others accompany them on this tour.

Meeting key staff

The tour of the venue may also include meeting key staff.

The type and extent of the function will determine who you should involve.

Internal staff

Obviously not every venue will have all of the following people, but the following list is indicative of who you might approach to help provide information to the potential customer:

- Property owner or manager
- Head Chef
- Food and Beverage manager



- Bar manager
- Dining room manager
- Head housekeeper
- Entertainment/event manager
- Functions manager
- Head of Security.

Meeting key staff is beneficial as it:

- Demonstrates the value you place in the customer
- The customer can build confidence in the organisation by observing the professionalism and competency of each staff member
- Enables each department to explain technical details and ways in which they can accommodate the customer's needs. For example a bride may wish to discuss wedding cakes with the hotel patisserie department
- Puts a face to a name, for both parties
- Enables each department to gain a detailed understanding of the customer's needs
- Enables staff members to confirm if specific requests can be met or any alterations that need to take place.



External staff

Not only is it important to arrange a meeting between the potential customer with internal staff, where external suppliers and specialist providers are required, it is important to either arrange a meeting between them or to pass on relevant contact details.

Advising customer in relation to details of the provision of similar functions

It is also important to be totally aware of all the services, facilities and products available within the venue that have been used in the past for functions and to consider how these may be adapted and included into developing future packages, deals or options for clients.

A range of ways in which to build customer confidence in your ability to meet the customer's needs include:

- Showing pictures of previous events
- Inviting them to view a similar event that is coming up
- Arranging past customers to provide a reference.



2.4 Provide advice and assistance in relation to the function

Introduction

Some clients have extensive experience with planning an event and many do not. Some clients will expect you to assist them in developing and planning their event and others will not.

Where required, it is important to provide advice and assistance where possible.

Identifying if the client needs planning assistance

You will gather a good idea of whether or not the client needs this type of assistance during the initial meeting with them.

You will form your judgement by virtue of:

- The questions they ask
- What they know about the venue and functions in general
- Any previous experience with functions they share with you
- Whether or not they are repeat clients.

If you are unsure about whether or not they require help it is acceptable to ask them if they do.

The main priority of providing advice and assistance is to acknowledge, accept and confirm requests made by customer. In addition any suggestions that can enhance a function should be suggested and explained.



Remaining client focussed

When you are developing ideas and options to assist the client in the development and planning of their function it is vital to remain client focussed.

It is essential the client believes your advice, suggestions and recommendations are being made to best meet their stated needs and preferences. It is very counter-productive for the client to believe they are being offered options and ideas which are solely of benefit to the venue by virtue of adding cost to the final bill.



Events and functions demand the client trusts and has confidence in the venue. As soon as the client starts thinking your focus is on 'money' (maximising revenue, optimising profit) and not on their needs, this trust and confidence quickly starts to evaporate.

Providing options and ideas

It is impossible to list all the different options and ideas you may need to assist the client with, but the following is an indicative list.

Function logistics

- Location. You may be able to suggest an alternative room in the venue that is different, and more appropriate, than the original room identified by the client. You will have a more intimate knowledge of what is available within the venue and the client is entitled to expect you to suggest the most appropriate space for their function or event
- Service styles
- Room layouts
- Timing considerations
- Entertainment options
- Ancillary services.



Menu options

This can include refining or adjusting choices presented in standard 'function kit' options by changing dishes, altering serving sizes, changing vegetables or salads.

Clients can also require advice in relation to the types of food suitable for buffets, finger food functions, 'on arrival' refreshments and food to be provided for morning and afternoon teas.

Your knowledge about specific foods to cater for stated health and cultural requirements will often be called on. Where you have insufficient knowledge in this regard you must involve the kitchen or head chef.

Beverage options

While many clients are relatively knowledgeable about food, most will require assistance when it comes to beverages.

The most common question regarding beverages relates not to types of beverages but to quantity and cost.

You will be expected to provide advice in relation to how much drink (alcoholic and non-alcoholic) will be required to cater for those attending the event.

Factors to consider are:

- Time of day the event is being held. The day of the week can also be influential
- Gender and age of those attending
- Type of function
- Whether or not those attending are staying in-house or will be departing after the function to go somewhere else.

In many cases you will also be asked to nominate specific wines and to a lesser extent beers and spirits to accompany meals, for use as the wine for toasts and to serve as pre-function drinks 'on arrival'.

Note that very few venues will offer an inclusive price for a meal (that is, a cost price that includes alcohol) so you will often be asked to provide a professional opinion about:

- How many bottles of alcohol should be allocated per table
- The amount of money the client should allocate for beverages if the event is to feature an 'open bar'

Technical requirements

In most situations the client will know what they want to achieve in terms of technical requirements but have relatively less knowledge about what is needed to achieve their intended outcome.

Your role is to assist them by explaining what items of equipment may be required and whether or not the venue provides them or whether they will have to be 'bought in'.

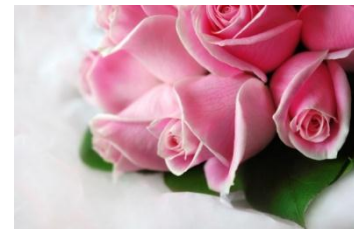


Most venues have a standard array of technical facilities and supplement this through hiring equipment and expertise from preferred suppliers.

Supplier options

Part of your role can be to identify potential suppliers to clients.

This occurs where the venue is unable to provide goods or services and the client has made it clear they must be provided.



Most venues will have a supplier file or similar that contains names and contact details of external suppliers the venue has used before and whose products and services they trust, and whose prices they believe to be competitive.

It is also common for the supplier file to contain a current catalogue and price list for each supplier. This catalogue and price list can be used to provide information to the client but should remain in the file.

Identify and pursue additional sales opportunities through effective communication with client

As mentioned before, it is not a good idea to provide suggestions solely based on improving the revenue of an event. That said, management will expect you to optimise revenue from any function the venue runs.

In many cases, your suggestions may prove to be advantageous to both parties.

It is important your attempts to make additional sales must occur within the limitations of house policies in this regard.

House policies

Very few venues will encourage or allow additional sales for functions to be pursued 'at any cost'.

Where there is a 'sell at any cost' mentality this can:

- Diminish the client's faith in us. They begin to believe we are only interested in the cash and not in their function
- Convince the client they should deal with another business.

Keys to identifying and pursuing additional sales

The critical point to remember when trying to optimise sales is to focus the suggestion to add value to the client's function rather than to add dollars to the bill.

This means anything you suggest must do one or more of the following:

Be appropriate

Whatever you suggest to increase sales to the client must be appropriate to the type of function being discussed and appropriate to the identified needs the client has already mentioned.

For example, it may be appropriate to suggest accommodation or a room for changing to a client who is discussing holding a wedding reception at your venue.



Fill a need the client has forgotten to address

For example, it is appropriate to suggest champagne for a toast to the bride and groom where the client has not mentioned it.

This is a standard part of a wedding reception and not mentioning it can be interpreted by the client as a failure on your part to provide a professional service.

Enhance the event

Where appropriate you should suggest activities, products or services that will improve the final function.

This involves suggesting things that will add a new dimension to the function that will accord with the guest profile, and align with the reason the function is being conducted.

Options will depend on the type of function and can include entertainment, local tours, meals, accommodation, and spa treatments.

Enhancing the function can also include suggesting up-graded services. This will depend on what the venue has to offer but might include valet parking for guests on arrival, airport pick-up of guests, or room service meals.

It is also possible to upsell the client by suggesting more expensive items such as meals, wines, rooms that will provide benefits for the guests and for the client. This may be in terms of increased prestige and improved image.



Effective communication with the guest

When trying to pursue additional sales opportunities it is important to remember this should never be done in any way that will jeopardise securing the original function.

To achieve this it is necessary to:

- Present the additional sales opportunities as 'options' and not as necessities. Never give the client the impression you are trying to force the suggestions on to them
- Accept the client's rejection of suggestions without being judgemental, without giving the client the impression they have made a poor decision or without giving the client the impression you are annoyed at them not accepting your suggestion

- Sell the benefits of the suggestion. Make the client aware of the benefits they may bring, such as extra enjoyment, increased prestige and better value for money
- Explain the suggestion. Describe what it is all about, what it entails, when it might be used and detail what it would complement
- Give examples of where you have seen the option included in an function and the impact it had, including positive feedback received from guests and clients
- Provide samples. If you are trying to convince the client to include spa treatments for guests at a week-long conference, and then let the client experience a massage.

It should be stated that the best way to optimise additional sales is to speak directly with the client, face to face.

This allows you to read the client, quickly pick up on their body language and decide what approach to take in response to their response.

Speaking face to face with the client also enables you to present samples of food, beverages, and activities.

2.5 Record function requirements as agreed by customer

Introduction

Throughout the meeting with the potential client it is important to write down detailed notes as the discussion takes place.

In many cases, there are many dimensions to a function and it is not expected that a functions staff member will be able to remember everything that the client says or requests.

Record decisions

It is best to let the client know at the start of the meeting that you will be recording information. This will help put them at ease that nothing will be forgotten.

Some function departments will have a dedicated template broken down into sections such as room type, set up and equipment so that relevant information is grouped together and in some cases a simple tick of the box is all that is needed.

By having an established template it also ensures that the functions staff member has a guide or list of questions which should be asked whilst the client is in their presence.



Repeating information

By writing down information, not only does it show that you are taking an interest in what they are saying, but that you want to ensure that you have recorded the information accurately.

At this stage, the key is to ensure that the information that you have recorded is accurate and a true reflection of what the client is looking for.

Further action

Once the client is happy with the information that you have recorded and are confident that you understand all their requirements, these can now be recorded for further use, including the preparing of a quotation.

Recording function requirements may include:

- Establishing Function Sheet
- Making provisional booking as stated by customer in the Functions Bookings book.



2.6 Confirm function booking with customer

Introduction

It is rare for anyone to be able to supply an accurate quotation to a client for a large function at or immediately after the initial meeting between the client and the venue.

Maintaining ongoing contact with customer

Follow up contact with the client

There are usually other things the client communicated to you after the initial meeting, and there are usually questions about the function you need answered before a realistic quotation can be prepared.

Even smaller functions often require additional contact with the client to obtain extra information. It is important you make contact every time you are faced with decisions about which of the client's preferences are unclear.

The reality of the situation is that you and the client will frequently not address all relevant points at the initial meeting that need to be covered. In some cases, you will ask the client a question and, at the initial meeting, they may not be able to give an answer.

In addition customers themselves may want to view facilities again, especially if a similar function is taking place.

Regular contact

Regular contact with a potential client is important just to let them know that you are thinking of them or at times to notify them if there are other enquiries on dates they have recommended.

The key is not to bombard them or place too much pressure on them to confirm. Quite often the person you are communicating with is not the final decision maker and therefore has no control as to the timing of a confirmation.

All you can do is to be supportive and available if they do have further questions.



Provide quotation to client

All potential clients will need to be supplied with a quotation for their function before they commit to booking it and paying a deposit.

Providing a quotation to a client is a serious business.

If the cost is too high, the client may elect not to proceed with the function.

If the quote is too low, the venue may not make enough profit or could even lose money.

Factors to take into account when developing a costing

The following are important points to bear in mind when developing a costing:

Follow house policies

Every venue will have its own protocols for determining the final cost of a function and it is essential you adhere to these. Where there is a chance to be involved with senior staff when they meet a client and cost a function, you should take advantage of that opportunity.

Make sure everything is charged for

It is essential that all charges which can be legitimately charged for are included in the quotation.

The information gathered from the initial meeting with the client together with subsequent contacts with the client will provide the basis for this.

Only include services and products the client has requested

While you are expected to suggest and pursue additional sales opportunities with all clients, the quotation should only cover the items that have been confirmed with the client.

If house policy requires additional potential services and products are included as part of the quotation they should be contained on a separate page and quite clearly indicated as options and not as part of the final quote.

Double-check your figures

It should be standard procedure to check and double-check all figures contained in the quote.

This need to check and double-check applies to:

- In-house charges, for example, for accommodation rooms, provision of in-house services (spa treatments, room hire, use of nominated facilities)
- Goods and services to be provided by external providers. Always check with suppliers to get up to date and accurate quotes from them regarding goods and services they are to provide
- Confirming house policy regarding charging for third party suppliers. Where the venue is using external providers to supply nominated goods and services you must know what the venue policy is regarding how these charges are to be passed on to the client. Some venues may charge these out 'at cost' and some may add a certain percentage as a fee to cover the time involved in arranging things
- Arithmetic calculations. You must check all your additions, extensions etc., are correct
- Including any discounts that may apply. These may apply to certain Very Important People (VIP) clients, or by virtue of their membership of some club or organisation.

Identify and explain every charge

It is standard procedure to ensure each and every charge the client is being asked to pay is individually identified and priced.

The intention is to provide the client with a detailed, clear and unambiguous quotation with no hint of deception or hidden costs.

In practice this means there can be a need to specify:

- The number of accommodation rooms included in the quotation and the type of room and in-room facilities
- Where a three course meal is offered the choices available for each course
- Where wine is being provided as part of the catering the number of bottles, the type and brand, style, vintage
- Where refreshments are being provided on arrival or during breaks exactly what will be provided
- If extra security is being charged for the number of security staff and the service they will be providing.

Observe promises made

Where you have promised the client certain facilities and services, it is essential these are included in the quotation to confirm to the client they will be provided.

Where you have promised the client their quotation will be provided by a given date, this promise must also be met. In the mind of the client, if you can't get the quotation done as promised it does not give them confidence in your ability to execute the function.

Verify with management

Always get management to double-check any quotation before it is presented to the client. Never present a quotation to a client unless you have specific authority to do so.

The experience and operational knowledge that management have can often raise an issue, cost or operating issue that you are unaware of, that has significant impact on the quotation.

Present the quotation in person

Where possible try to meet with the client when you present the quotation. This enables you to explain the various charges.

If the client simply receives a postal or e-mailed quotation their focus can often be on the cost and they may fail to appreciate the value for money the proposal represents.

Negotiate and agree upon final event details, with confirmation in writing provided to client, including financial and other conditions

All functions and events require some form of negotiation with the client due to the individual nature of the occasions and the unique needs and preferences of the client.

When these negotiations have been concluded it is standard practice to prepare written information for the client detailing what the arrangements are.

This provides the client with an opportunity to verify the arrangements and to add or vary any issues they want to change.

This final confirmation also serves to provide a basis for an original quotation or to prepare a revised quotation based on the changed circumstances that have been agreed to.

The process of negotiating

Negotiating with clients can relate to:

Price

Price is nearly always an issue when negotiating functions. The client wants the best price and the venue needs to obtain its identified profit margin.

Most venues have set prices for products and services and there is traditionally little room to manoeuvre in terms of negotiating price.

You may be authorised to negotiate price where this is specifically identified in your 'scope of authority'. For example you may have permission to reduce prices by a nominated percentage (say, 5%) in order to secure a function.

Where you have no such scope of authority your options are limited to referring the negotiations to management or explaining to the client that your price is your 'best price'. In many cases price can often be seen as a 'take it or leave it' situation.

Where price is an issue the primary way of reducing it is to reduce what is to be offered.

This may include:

- Reducing courses at a meal – from three to two
- Substituting a less expensive wine for the wines already quoted on
- Substituting less expensive menu items into the meal options
- Not including liquor in the function – meaning guests have to pay for their own
- Limiting the time the function runs which can reduce staffing costs
- Removing a previously identified activity from the function such as the band or having a smaller band, entertainment, side tours and other inclusions.



Timing

This relates to price in that some functions may be able to be delivered at a price that suits the client if the hours or days for the function are reduced.

Timing negotiations can also include discussion and agreement about:

- Days the function is to be held. Your venue may be able to offer a better deal at a time when business is traditionally slow
- Timing of guest arrival. Staff costs can be reduced by shortening the amount of time between guest arrival and the start of the function
- Decisions regarding the timing of activities within the function itself such as when meals are to be served, when different courses are to be served, when speeches are to take place, when morning and afternoon teas are to be served

- Access to the function area for client personnel
- Times/dates by which the event must be finished.

Goods and services to be provided

It may be possible to assist the client by curtailing expenses in terms of:

- Providing their own cake even though the venue will still charge a fee per person for cutting, plating etc
- Providing cheaper dessert items
- Removing the 'pre-event' drinks
- Decreasing the amount, or changing the type of, decorations to be supplied
- Eliminating flowers
- Not including accommodation.



Preparing the Function Contract

Once the function details have been verbally confirmed with the customer, standard practice requires a written agreement to be drawn up and signed by all parties involved.

This agreement is generally a pro forma document requiring you to simply complete various pieces of 'missing' information.

The function contract is generally sealed by the payment of a deposit to secure the booking.

When negotiations have concluded you must be in possession of the following information which may need to be included in your function contract:

- Full contact details of the client
- Type of function – such as wedding, product launch, or business seminar, including service style (buffet, seated, finger-food), seating arrangements for meals, seminars, group sessions etc. This indicates how the tables, chairs, stages, head tables and other items of equipment will be laid out
- Dates and times of the function
- Date for notification of final numbers
- Location of the function, name of rooms and facilities to be used
- Approximate numbers attending
- Décor, displays, table decorations etc
- Food to be served including when, type, amount
- Beverages to be served – as above
- Entertainment, activities and inclusions
- Ancillary sales such as accommodation by type, number and dates, tours, in-house services, provision of a Master of Ceremonies (MC) or host, photographers



- Services and facilities the venue has agreed to provide at no charge such as table for presents, change room for the Bride and Groom, use of pool and gymnasium facilities
- Technology required to support the function – data projectors, stage, sound and lighting requirements, DVD players etc
- Access required by the client prior to the function
- Products and services the client will be supplying
- Involvement of third party suppliers
- Total cost of function broken down into all the component areas, not just the traditional food and beverage elements. The more items you can point to in this section, the better value for money the function will appear to the client
- Deposit amount – the amount you are asking for as a deposit and how that figure was calculated, and when it is payable
- Preferred method and date for final payment. Where an account for final payment is to be forwarded, this section will also include confirmation of who is to get the account and the address where the account is to be sent. Payment by cheque may be acceptable in some instances otherwise cash or more commonly credit card is preferred. Where the venue knows the client and is assured of their credit rating they may be prepared to send an account payment is normally required within a relatively short timeframe (7 – 14 days) as opposed to 30 days plus
- Refund policy – explaining the conditions under which the venue is prepared to offer a refund of a deposit, how much the deposit will be
- Payment for extra persons. As previously mentioned a figure should be stated indicating how much the venue will charge if there are additional people attending the function.



Booking conditions

All venues will have specific booking conditions. These will usually appear on the website and form part of the standard function contract.

The conditions will be very specific in what they require of the client but often these are 'diluted' somewhat to accommodate individual client needs and to ensure the venue secures the function rather than loses it simply because they refused to be flexible in meeting client needs or because they were pig headed about insisting every aspect of every booking condition be fulfilled.

Booking conditions may include reference to:

- How long the client has to sign the function contract (7 days is common) including mention that the venue may sell the dates and times of the function to another party until the contract is signed and a deposit paid
- Need for the client to provide information by a set date that has not yet been provided but which is essential to the planning and preparation for the event
- Need for the client to advise the venue within a set time (48 hours) of any inaccuracies contained in the contract, running sheet etc

- Ability of the client to make changes (up or down) to expected numbers to a given percentage (say 10%) up to 7 days before the function
- Where a decrease in numbers is notified according to this timeframe the conditions may indicate no penalty applies providing agreed 'minimum numbers' are attained
- Where an increase in numbers is notified a maximum number of extra people may be indicated as will the extra cost per person and there may be mention of the need to move to different rooms which may necessitate a higher room charge fee
- Payment. This can stipulate how payment is made and dates for payment
- The conditions may state that where the client requires a credit account with the venue this must be formally applied for, and that all accounts are required to be paid on 'net 30 days' terms
- This section also explains that where the venue produces an incorrect account (that is, one that is less than what it should be or one that omits a charge that should have been made) the venue retains the right to issue a supplementary account to recover these costs



- Cancellation policy. This applies where the total function has to be cancelled and sets out the percentage refund the client would be entitled where a deposit has been made and the timing issues that apply (for example, X% refund if cancellation occurs before XX/XX/XX but a lesser percentage if the cancellation is received after that date)
- Some venues may base their refund/cancellation statements on 'profit'. In such a case the venue will retain %X (say, 30%) of the quoted cost for food and beverage regarded as being the lost gross profit for the function.



Some venues may be prepared to refund the majority of the monies paid (say 90%) where they can resell the dates/rooms that have been cancelled

- Right of the venue to make changes. This gives the venue the right 'under extenuating circumstances' to alter any agreed part of the agreement provided they supply suitable alternative arrangements
- 'Force majeure'. Most contracts will contain a condition stating that in the event of 'force majeure' instances which includes things such as riots, war, terrorism, natural disasters and fire the venue will not be held liable
- Right of the venue to refuse certain activities or individuals. While Equal Opportunity legislation must be observed the venue will nearly always retain the right to prohibit certain people or activities on their premises
- Naturally this area is a sensitive one but the venue will often seek to protect its reputation, not to mention protect its physical assets, staff and other customers, by banning nominated activities. This means the venue will have, for example, the right to refuse to have a certain band play at the venue if it believes that band to be 'inappropriate'

- There is usually also some statement reminding the client that the venue has the right and legal obligation to remove anyone from the premises whose presence on the premises renders the venue liable to an offence under law
- Conditions that apply to decorating and using the venue. This will indicate the actions that the client can and cannot take when they are involved in preparing for the function. Common inclusions here are that the client cannot stick anything to walls, cannot nail anything in place and must ensure all items used are safe
- Loss and damage stipulating the client must accept responsibility for any loss or damage they cause to the venue
- Check-in and check-out times for accommodation rooms that are being included as part of the function. This will also extend to bump-in, bump-out times.



2.7 Obtain deposit for function

Introduction

It is standard industry practice to request a deposit when the final details of a function have been confirmed.

Every venue has its own policy on the amount of deposit required to secure a function and this must be strictly adhered to. Due to the nature of the work, preparation and need to order stock such as food and beverages for a function, the deposit required is commonly substantial.

No function exists until a deposit has been paid.

Requesting the deposit

You may have blocked the required areas for an anticipated function, but it remains 'tentative' until a deposit has been secured and a contract signed.

In practical terms, this means a tentative function may be bumped where another client is prepared to pay a deposit and sign a contract for the same days.

Confirmation – and certainly the contract – may be in writing but, again, it is best to communicate this confirmation at a face to face meeting where ambiguities can be cleared up, explanations given and final changes made.

The face to face meeting allows you to pick up on any non-verbal cues that may indicate hesitation, reluctance or disagreement on the part of the client and address them as appropriate.

A personal meeting also sends the message you are taking this function seriously, and that it matters to you and the venue.

Whilst getting the details finalised are obviously important, it is equally important that you remain flexible about certain aspects of the function.

Naturally the date and time are fixed, and to an extent the numbers must likewise be guaranteed. A minimum number is usually required to be paid for, and numbers above a set figure are required to be paid for at \$X per head.

Dates for notifying final numbers are also immovable when they have been agreed to.

However, many other aspects of a function cannot be set in concrete, and by their nature must be 'set in jelly'.

Steps associated with handling deposits

Each organisation will be different in terms of the policies and procedures to be followed when handling deposit requests. That said, common steps to follow include:

- Requesting deposit payment. This can be based on a standard establishment requirement such as percentage of estimated or quoted final cost
- Setting date for payment of deposit. This is important as it helps to determine the seriousness of the potential client and in addition allows a conference department to release a function room with adequate time to rebook it
- Advising of payment options. Many hospitality organisations will have established payment options including:
 - Charge back to company. This normally requires a credit check to be conducted and also some guaranteeing method of payment to be recorded
 - EFT – this is a common form of payment enabling money to be transferred electronically from the client's bank account into that of the hotel
 - Cash – not a common method but certainly a preferred option
 - Debit and credit cards. These may be processed, either as a pre-payment or a pre-authorisation. This can be conducted face to face when the client is at the establishment or done via email using appropriate procedures
- Issuing receipt for deposit – this normally accompanies the confirmation
- Recording payment of deposit on internal documentation. Normally the functions department will obtain a record of the payment, either through the financial department or via front office, if the payment was made face to face
- It is essential that regardless of where and how the payment was received, that it is recorded on file, normally through the establishment of a house account dedicated to the function
- In addition, it is essential that the functions department is aware of when it is made, so that they can issue a receipt in a timely manner and to ensure they aren't following up a payment which already has been made
- Advising customer of amount outstanding. If there is any amount outstanding from the agreed deposit amount or for payments required for external suppliers, this must be followed up according to organisational policy.



Updated financial information

When the client pays a deposit for a function an account is usually opened for them at this stage.

- It is vital the first entry on this account shows their deposit and places their account in credit
- Make sure you check the details of any account that is prepared, verifying correct figures, names, addresses
- It may be company policy to mail the client a copy of this, or a receipt or both for monies received. A copy of all paperwork relating to payments received must also be placed in the function file so that anyone looking at the file knows immediately what the financial status of the file is
- As further payments are made by the client these too must be entered onto the account and updated in the function file. For example 'progress payments' may have been negotiated for large functions, where there is a relatively long lead-time and large expenses have been accumulated
- It is important the function file contains these details relating to account status as often the venue representative and the client will meet at times when the accounts department is closed and this information cannot be obtained, if needed
- Similarly, expenses are posted as appropriate reflecting purchases that have been made in relation to the function. These figures are essential for post-function administration and analysis.



Preparing confirmations

A standard pro forma confirmation is sent to the client when they have signed the function contract and paid a deposit.

This confirmation acknowledges the contract has been signed and that money has been paid and received.

In addition a copy of the Function Sheet is also sent which gives brief details about the basics of the function including type, dates, times, numbers, brief menu. This is explained in more detail in the next section.

Confirmations serve to give the client confidence the function has been secured and will go ahead.

Confirmations may also be sent by the venue to suppliers and third party providers once the function has been confirmed, advising what the venue requires them to provide for the function and letting them know it is going ahead.

Confirmation to the client should be in hard copy form whilst confirmation to suppliers can be email, fax or phone.

It is also important to ensure that the function is written as confirmed in the Functions Booking book.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

2.1 Research and identify:

- How to identify customer needs
- Types of customer needs.

2.2. Research and identify the different types of requirements that a client may have when arranging a function

2.3. Research and identify how to match establishment resources to identified need for function

2.4. Research and identify:

- How to identify if the client needs planning assistance
- Options and ideas that can be provided to the client.

2.5 Explain why it is important to record function requirements as indicated by the client

2.6 Research and identify the steps associated with confirming a function booking with the customer

2.7 Research and identify the steps associated with obtaining a deposit for a function

Summary

Liaise with function customers

Determine customer needs

- Meeting with the client
- Understanding customer needs.

Identify date and time of function

- Timing
- Type of function
- Size and type of room
- Numbers attending
- Catering
- Technical equipment
- Access
- Themes and decorations
- Security
- Media
- Use of external suppliers
- Other possible needs
- Conducting research.

Match establishment resources to identified need for function

- Describing function facilities and options available
- Giving Function Kit to customer and explaining the contents
- Providing guided tour of premises and facilities to customer
- Meeting key staff
- Advising customer in relation to details of the provision of similar functions.

Provide advice and assistance in relation to the function

- Identifying if the client needs planning assistance
- Remaining client focussed
- Providing options and ideas
- Identify and pursue additional sales opportunities through effective communication with client.

Record function requirements as agreed by customer

- Record decisions
- Repeating information
- Further action.

Confirm function booking with customer

- Maintaining ongoing contact with customer
- Provide quotation to client
- Negotiate and agree upon final event details, with confirmation in writing provided to client, including financial and other conditions
- Preparing the Function Contract
- Booking conditions.

Obtain deposit for function

- Requesting the deposit
- Steps associated with handling deposits
- Updated financial information
- Preparing confirmations.

Element 3: Prepare for functions

3.1 Maintain and update Function Sheet

Introduction



In many hospitality organisations, it is common for functions to be confirmed, with deposits made, well in advance of the actual function date. This is especially true of large functions and weddings which may be booked up to a year in advance.

As mentioned in the last section, a copy of the function sheet will identify what has been confirmed at the time of the function confirmation.

Preparing function sheets

It is standard practice to prepare a function sheet as a means of communicating with staff about an upcoming function.

A function sheet, sometimes also known as an 'event order' or 'function order', is an internal communication form developed to suit each venue's needs that sets out the details of a function such as:

- Type of function – wedding, launch of product, ball
- Name, address, and contact number of client
- Day, date and time of the function
- Rooms and locations where the function will be held
- Billing instructions – who gets the bill, their address
- Menu – break-down course by course of the agreed dishes including specification of 'on arrival' food, morning and afternoon teas
- Beverage arrangements – description and quantities of beverages to be provided
- Sequence of service – covering timing of service, and details of when speeches and presentations will occur
- Entertainment – details of bands and the order of ceremony.
- Room set up – number of tables, floor plan, decorations, table set-ups including cutlery, crockery and table accoutrements
- Type of service – plated, tray, buffet, silver service, finger food
- Special requirements – commonly relating to technology requirements such as microphone, DVD facilities, data projector, sound and lighting.



Maintaining and updating Function Sheet

Whilst the Function Sheet may be accurate at the time of the function booking and confirmation, there will be changes which need to be updated and communicated to relevant internal departments and external suppliers.

Updating Function Sheet

When any changes to a function are identified the Function Sheet must be updated by:

- Amending Function File on the basis of requests from customer including finalisation of menus and beverages, confirmation of times, and adding new requests for products and services
- Adding details to the file regarding function-related activities including booking of entertainers, confirmation of external services to be provided, and timing of service.

Identification of changes

As more and more changes are made, it may become hard to identify which copy of a Function Sheet is the most updated and accurate.

It is essential that each updated version of the Function Sheet is marked in some way so as to identify the version.

This identification can come in the form of a version number depicted by:

- Numerical identification – 1,2,3
- Date identification – identifying date of version.



Discussing changes

It is also important that any updated versions are given to the appropriate people in a timely manner and that they understand the changes that have been made and how they impact the department of staff member.

Email

This can come in the form of an email with the following instructions letting the sender know the status of the email including:

- Notification - when the email has been opened
- Read Receipt – sent by the recipient when they have read and understood the changes.

In person

Updated Function Sheets may be distributed and explained in meetings, allowing all relevant people time to discuss the changes and how best to implement them. Given that the logistics of a function impacts a number of departments, it is essential they all understand and agree on the changes to be made.

Alternatively the function staff member may personally deliver the updated version in hand to ensure that it is not only been given to the correct person, but allows them to discuss updates and changes with different colleagues and staff. This format is used when changes are made at the last minute, which is very common in functions.

Keeping accurate records

Where many functions are conducted, the establishment will have some form of function file. This is a paper-based file that details the progress of all functions on an individual basis.

A separate function file, to accompany a Function Sheet, is created for each function. In practice the function file may be initiated as soon as an enquiry is received from a prospective client regarding a function.

Details kept in the file include anything to do with the function. This might include:

- Contact details of client
- Quotations provided to client
- Quotations received from suppliers for goods and services for the function
- List of charges that must be made against the client
- Special requirements as identified by the client
- Records of suggestions made by the venue
- Case notes outlining the meetings that have been held between the venue and the client, what was discussed, problems arising, solutions and suggestions agreed on, an indication of what the next step was to be. That is, if the venue had promised to take some action, or if the venue was to wait for advice from the client
- Written correspondence from the client
- Copies of accounts rendered to the client and payments received from the client.

Large premises need a function file because the client may not deal with the same venue person every time and yet there needs to be continuity of contact and an uninterrupted flow of information so as to build confidence, regardless of who the client speaks to.

Where this file is made public and can be used during meetings between the client and the venue, you need to be very careful about what is written in it, just in case the client asks to look at it or in situations where you need to clarify a point by showing the file to the client. Make sure nothing offensive or derogatory is ever entered into the file.



3.2 Advise colleagues and staff in relation to function

Introduction

The previous section started to explore the need for communication amongst internal departments and external suppliers in ensuring a function is planned and prepared in a timely manner, with all parties working towards clear and collective goals.

This section will continue to explore the relationship between different people playing a part in preparing a function.

Liaise with appropriate colleagues and suppliers to facilitate effective planning of event services

All successful functions are a result of effective teamwork.

This highlights the need to involve others in the planning phase so that the implementation works as required.

It is vital you appreciate the need to proactively include others in the planning stage especially those who will be participating in the preparation and execution of the function.

Never be afraid of asking for input from people in relation to planning these occasions.

Types of assistance

There are many types of assistance that may be required, either to be given or received, by different stakeholders in a function, including:

- Seeking advice or suggestions
- Confirming information
- Updating them about preparations and purchases
- Undertaking logistical activities and arrangements
- Assisting them to meet function requirements.

Who might be involved?

The following is indicative of who you may liaise with when planning a function:

- Food requirements discussed with Executive Chef
- Beverage requirements discussed with Beverage Manager
- Technical requirements discussed with Maintenance Department or outside suppliers
- Linen requirements discussed with housekeeping. Outside suppliers may also be involved
- Room decorations and floral arrangements discussed with housekeeping or outside suppliers
- Facility set-up requirements discussed with Catering and Food and Beverage or functions coordinator
- Security information and requirements discussed with the Security Department
- Arrival and departure information discussed with Front Office Department.

What input can these people make?

Essentially you are asking these people to make input based on:

- Their previous experience
- Their specialist areas of expertise
- Their individual knowledge of the venue, what it can do, what it has to offer and what it has done successfully and unsuccessfully in the past.

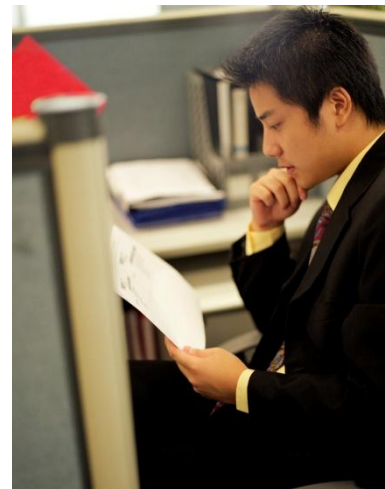
Why involve them?

The benefit of involving these people should mean:

- You are more aware of other factors that could impact on the function as a result of information from these people about other happenings in the venue
- The venue avoids repeating previous mistakes they have made in other functions
- The venue is able to play to its strengths in terms of service delivery, staff expertise, facilities etc.

Examples of issues that can be more successfully addressed during planning if the right people are involved include:

- Special needs on the menu to accommodate vegetarians, cultural or special dietary needs
- Advice on a certain aspect of the function relating to the use of technology, specialist equipment etc
- Availability of specific facilities, rooms, staff, locations, equipment etc
- Input regarding table setting requirements – specific linen colours, accoutrements, table sizes, table plans, service issues, especially as they relate to timing
- Advice on a particular beverage being available for the function to match beverages with food, to meet cost limitations and to ensure sufficient availability
- Assistance on the possibility of extending liquor trading hours and obtaining authorisation to trade in different areas.



Obtaining advice from others

Seeking advice from colleagues or management is usually done formally at a scheduled meeting where time is allocated for everyone to discuss the function and make input.

Sometimes, however, there can be a need to obtain help from people without notice.

For example, where you have the client with you in the office, and have to ring a colleague to find an answer to their question. In these cases it is advisable to say something like “Chef, I have Mr Walsh with me in the office. He wants some information on our \$40 per head set menu – have you got a minute to speak to us?”

Notifying the person on the other end of the phone that the client is with you can help avoid many potentially embarrassing situations. The same advice holds true if you are phoning a supplier to make an enquiry.

3.3 Roster staff for function

Introduction

One of the key requirements when planning for a function is to ensure that you are adequately staffed for the event.

This is normally undertaken through the use of a roster.

A roster is a plan that organises staff, indicating which staff are to work where and at what times.

The purpose of rosters can be seen as ensuring that the right people, in the right number, are employed at the right places at the right time.



This is always a unique challenge in functions, as each function is often different from another, with different levels and skill sets required based on a number of impacts, as identified below.

Reasons for having rosters

There are five reasons why organisations have rosters.

Four of these relate to the effective and efficient running of the business, while the fifth relates to individual employees.

Organising staff

Rostering is a means of organising staff.

It enables the supervisor to know who is working on a particular shift and who is not.

It enables the workload to be distributed fairly among staff and over time.

Balancing experienced staff

Rostering enables skilled workers to be on duty with people who are not so experienced. In this way, rosters ensure the customer is adequately served by staff in both numbers and skills.

This will be explained in more detail later in this section.

This is an effective and efficient use of staff.

Rostering also tells the organisation where various staff are deployed or why they are not at work. In many organisations, there is a direct link via computer software between the roster, the timesheet and payroll services.

Communicating

Rostering is a means of communicating with employees, to inform them of when they are required for work and when their leave days are available to be taken.

Good rosters reflect to the employee the busy periods and the goals of the organisation in terms of service.

In some cases, the roster may indicate to the employee what location and work they will be doing at a given time.

Cost controlling

Rostering is a definite way of controlling labour costs.

It ensures enough people are working for each function.

Rostering allows work to be distributed in a cost efficient manner while ensuring service to consumers is not diminished.

Aiding employees

Rosters enable individual employees to better plan and manage their personal and work time.

It enables them to plan for their holidays and 'time off' in advance.

Impacts on staffing

The amount and type of staff required to service a function will greatly depend on the:

- Type of function
- Service requirements
- Numbers attending
- Level of service required
- Host of associated miscellaneous details.

Sometimes the number of staff required is determined by the client. The budget they have available will dictate staffing levels.

Sometimes the venue will 'contribute' staff where this is deemed appropriate. This may occur when:

- The client is a regular, high-spending client and the venue wishes to make a tangible donation to the function
- The venue wishes to clear, clean and strip a room so it may be quickly re-set and re-used for another function. It may be the case a room is used for a lunch meeting and is also booked for a dinner function the same day. This would require extra staff to organise things and make sure both functions can be accommodated.



Calculating staff numbers

Determining how many staff are needed or can be afforded for a function is based on a number of factors.

Roles to be performed

Each function is unique and therefore a great deal of thought needs to go into what each staff member will be required to do during the actual event. The following provides an overview of staffing needs for different function types:

Breakfast Function – Self-service – Continental Menu

- Staff to set up and service the buffet
- Staff to greet and seat customers

- Waiting staff to clear away unwanted crockery, cutlery and glassware
- Staff to clean up function and set for lunch.

Cocktail Party – Informal Function – Stand up

- Staff to set up function area
- Bar staff to set up and run the bar
- Waiting staff to carry platters of food
- Staff to clean up the area after function.

Formal dinner party

- Staff to set up function area
- Bar staff to set up and run the bar
- Waiting staff to provide semi-silver service to guests
- Staff to clean up the area after function
- Security staff.



General party

- Staff to assist with decorations
- Bar staff to set up and run the bar
- Staff to coordinate and play music (DJ)
- Staff to carry platters of food
- Security staff.

Productivity standards

Every job has standards of performance that are required to be met by the employee undertaking that job.

Each organisation will have different 'expected levels of output' required for each staff member depending on the type of activities that they are required to perform.

Performance standards are targets and as such, where possible, should be expressed objectively. Examples of productivity standards may include:

- Food waiters may be expected to serve X number of people
- One bar tender is used to serve X number of customers.

Naturally, depending on the style of service, the expected output will vary but some form of standard will exist. For example staff undertaking silver service will be able to service fewer customers, than for a buffet function.

Budget

The person drawing up rosters of functions needs to consider relevant staff budgets that have been allocated to their department or section.

Issues to note are:

- Forecasting labour costs for the period covered by the roster – how much money is available for staffing
- Ensuring all hours are covered and the wages or labour costs for the roster are within the allowable labour budget for each function.

Many establishments will forecast sales and revenue for the function in question, and that will determine the dollar figure available for labour, because they operate on a 'percentage of sales' labour budget.

In effect, the greater the revenue generated for a function, the more staff you can use. Correspondingly, less revenue means that fewer staff are available.

This scenario means management allocates the amount that can be spent, and it is up to you how you spend it.

The cost of employing someone does not just mean their wages, but also includes many other costs. Examples of these include workers' compensation insurance, superannuation, payroll tax and leave entitlements.

All supervisors have a responsibility to keep labour costs down while maintaining customer service level. This may be one of the ways your employer judges your workplace performance.



Allocating the right mix of staff

When rostering staff it is essential to use the available skills bases or skill sets and competencies of available staff to match the type of function. This is aimed at obtaining the most effective and appropriate mix of staff to meet different operational requirements and constraints. Given the nature of different functions and the fact that staff are not normally employed on a regular basis in a functions environment, it is essential that there is a 'right mix' of staff.

Consideration of the mix of staff for a specific function is done so the staff who are rostered on, complement each other and therefore provide balanced and total service to customers.

Factors influencing the mix of staff

This balance and mix may include attention to:

- The mix of experienced staff and new staff. The new staff may include trainees, those who are newly employed but who may have experience only in other establishments, people on work experience, staff who have just been promoted, and employees who are making a transition, perhaps as part of a multi-skilling focus, into the area but who may have experience within the venue in another department
- The mix of permanent and casually employed staff. Most casual staff do not have the same knowledge of an organisation as permanent staff do. They may not know where items are located, how procedures are to be performed and the different people who work in the functions and kitchen area. In addition, they normally will not have the same sense of responsibility as permanent staff. Therefore it is important that there are qualified permanent staff who can help direct, lead and assist casually employed staff
- The mix of males to females. Many establishments prefer a gender balance in their staff to cater for the various needs of their clientele. In addition, there may be certain roles that are traditionally occupied by one gender, equal opportunity legislation notwithstanding

- The mix of skilled employees to semi-skilled employees. This also highlights that staff with lots of experience are not necessarily those with skills. Skills and years of service are not always the same, although many staff tend to believe this is in fact the case. You may require a majority of staff in your functions area to have only basic plate carrying, service and clearing skills, while you will always want to have two on duty who have high levels of silver service and gueridon skills
- The mix of language skills. For some functions it could be critical to ensure an adequate mix of people with various language abilities.

Accessing staff

In many cases, functions do not have a ready pool of staff available at its disposal to cater for an event and may need to access staff through:

- Other departments
- Other hotels within the chain
- Specialist contractors
- Casual employment
- Employment agencies.



Venues often keep a list of people they can call on to work at functions. These are predominantly casual staff who have worked on functions at the venue before and who have proved their worth and competency. It is a fact that staff who do not perform at functions, are never rehired.

In addition, some permanent venue staff will be allocated to work the function. These staff may well be more competent or multi-skilled staff who can work quicker, who know the run of the venue better, or who have more function experience and so on. Note that allocating normal dining room staff to a function may leave the dining room understaffed for that time so additional staff have to be hired to backfill that department.

Confirming staff

Because events/functions are one-off in nature staff used on them will often need to be confirmed.

This means contacting them to determine their availability and their willingness to work. Organising of staff must be done in advance. It must never be left to the last minute.

Once rosters have been determined, by whatever means the enterprise uses, they must be communicated to staff within appropriate and designated timelines.

Information to communicate

Remember, you must be quite specific with all function staff about when they start, when they finish and exactly what their tasks are to be. Functions are sometimes seen by staff as opportunities to earn extra cash.

All staff must be made aware of their working hours, and of the fact that no overtime will be paid unless approved by the appropriate person.



Methods of communicating confirmation

- Typically a copy of the roster will be posted on the noticeboard within the workplace. This is not always effective when a large amount of casual staff are used, many of whom may not be on the premises on a regular basis
- Distributing hard copies to individual staff
- Phoning or texting staff members. This is the quickest method to both send requests and receive confirmation of shifts
- E-mailing electronic copies to staff either at their work-based e-mail address or to their private home e-mail
- Distribution may be supplemented by mentioning the roster for the next week or fortnight at a weekly staff meeting.

Calculating staff hours

The hours staff spend actually working on a function need to be accurately calculated and documented for costing and function evaluation and review purposes.

Staff costs are a significant expense to the venue for functions and failure to properly control this expense item can quickly turn a profitable function into a loss-making situation.

It should also be realised that time spent by management should be factored in to staffing costs. There is likely to be a significant time fraction spent with the client, discussing menus, touring the venue, explaining options, planning, working on behalf of the client (with suppliers, perhaps with delegates, with their staff) and there can be a need to justify this time and resulting costs and charges made against the function.

Calculating labour cost percentages

Managers may use 'labour cost percentage' as a check on labour costs compared to total sales.

If labour cost percentage is too high then this may indicate:

- There are too many staff
- The way they are rostered is inefficient; for example staff are being paid excessive overtime and/or penalty rates because they are being asked to work hours outside those normally provided for under the award
- Revenue has not matched expectations. Sufficient customers and sales have not been attracted in the way we believed it would for the period in question.

Labour cost percentage is calculated by dividing the labour cost by the sales, and multiplying by 100 over 1. For example:

Labour cost x 100

Sales 1

Assume: Sales \$8550 and Labour Costs \$2250

Labour cost percentage would be calculated as follows:

$$\frac{\$2250}{\$8550} \times \frac{100}{1} = 26.3\%$$

The labour cost percentage for these figures is thus 26.3%.

In the above example, if management had set a labour cost percentage target of 30%, you would be happy because you have come in under budget. If the target was 25%, then you would have come in slightly over budget.

Where you come in over budget, some establishments may allow you to carry this forward to next time, and retrieve the situation in the next period.

Likewise, where you come in under budget this time this may allow you to spend slightly more next time.

In other establishments, each period stands alone, and you are expected to meet budget every time. No carryovers are permitted.

These calculations are done before the roster is put in place to make sure it is within budget, and then the same calculations are done after the period, using the actual figures that have emerged, to see how the costed roster compared to the actual roster. This allows anything over budget to be identified and factored in to the next roster, meaning cutbacks will probably have to be made.



3.4 Minimise impact of function on normal establishment operation

Introduction

Most function departments within a hotel are very busy places, with a number of events being held at the same time. Not only is it important that each function is planned and conducted successfully but that they do not greatly impact on other functions and the general activities undertaken in a hotel by other customers.

This does not mean that people attending functions are less worthy than dining patrons or in-house guests, but more that each person using the hotel facilities is not greatly impacted by others and are able to use the facilities as intended.

Therefore an important part of the planning process is to determine likely impacts of a function and explore ways to minimise these impacts. Not only does this include impacts a function will have on others, but what factors may impact on the function itself.

When organising a function it is important to identify any possible flow-on effects it might have on the property, and take action to minimise any negative consequences and optimise any positive consequences.

Identify and consider possible event impacts and take appropriate action to address these impacts

Shortage of staff

It is always possible more guests arrive for a function than planned for or staff members rostered to work may call in sick.

An emergency list of staff, with phone numbers, who can be called in at very short notice must be compiled and managers should know where to source current staff from until the crisis passes.

By 'borrowing' someone from room service, someone from another function, two from the dining room and one from the bar it may be possible to struggle through until help arrives, or until things ease off.

Management should not be shy in pitching in to help as necessary.

Loss of power or IT connections

Power failure and failure of technology is a constant source of worry during functions.

The failure of speakers or data projectors to function as required can turn an otherwise successful occasion into a disaster.

To effectively address this potential problem, pre-planning is imperative.

Some venues have a stand-by generator to accommodate power failure and this is an obvious first step to consider.

For addressing IT problems you should consider having a suitable qualified technician in attendance, or staff with relevant experience and appropriate ability.

Equipment malfunctions

Equipment is always subject to failure without notice and options to address this include having back-up items available which may be able to be borrowed from other areas within the venue, hiring replacement units and having them on stand-by just in case or having a maintenance person on duty to fix them.

Excess noise affecting other areas of the business

Realistically, most functions produce some form of noise and it is a safe bet that it will upset someone, interrupt someone, or disturb someone's sleep. All you can do is apologise and perhaps offer some discount or complimentary service.

Appropriate planning can help minimise this potential.

Reception staff may be able to minimise possible complaints from in-house functions by not selling rooms above or immediately adjacent to the function area.

Using security staff to 'escort' patrons to their cars may also help keep the noise on leaving under control.



Locating the function in a space not frequented by other patrons may be an option. Some venues will restrict access to certain areas which are normally open to the public while a function is on, thereby preventing members of the public being impacted by the function.

Shortage of food and beverage products and any associated items

Adequate planning and calculations should avoid this situation but the unpredictable can always occur resulting in shortages.

Keys to avoid problems are:

- Count items in stock to know how much you have and never assume you know what is available. Make arrangements to buy, hire or borrow whatever is needed
- Be aware that while a function is in progress other parts of the venue have to be able to operate as normal. The function can rarely be allowed to monopolise all venue resources so make sure other bars and dining areas are still able to deliver the service levels needed for other patrons

- Use in-venue history to help determine what demand will be on all resources necessary. Figures and evaluations from previous functions can be extremely useful in determining what is needed or what problems might occur
- Have a Plan B for instances where food and menu items run out. It is essential the kitchen is able to supply a meal of some sort where the agreed menu items run out.

Unacceptable behaviour

Functions and events often give rise to unacceptable behaviour.

This behaviour may be unacceptable to other attendees at the function or unacceptable to other venue patrons who are not part of the function.

Prevention is better than cure in these situations and constant monitoring of behaviour by security staff, operational staff and management coupled with early intervention is critical.

Standard procedure in some venues as a first response to unacceptable behaviour is to notify function coordinators who may include committee members, team leaders, captains, and treasurers where behaviour is a problem and ask them to intervene.

Where this fails to resolve the situation, normal procedures for dealing with trouble makers should be followed.

The standard orientation is to hope for the best, and plan for the worst.

Disruption to normal service caused by closure of room/areas

Depending on the size or location of the event, other areas outside the dedicated function rooms may be used exclusively for a function. This means that it is not open for the use of other in-house guests.

This may include but not be limited to:

- Gardens – for use of cocktail parties and weddings
- Restaurants – for private parties and birthdays.

It is essential that if an area is closed, that arrangements can be made elsewhere to accommodate in-house guests. For example if a restaurant is closed, the same menu may be available for room service or in the bar.

Restricted access to the venue

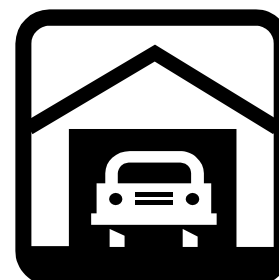
At times, VIPs such as heads of state may be attending functions. In these cases, security levels may be higher than usual, with access restricted to certain areas.

Notices may be sent to in-house guests notifying them of the added security measures put into place.

Reduced availability of parking for regular customers

Naturally, the larger an event, the more car spaces that will be taken up by participants of these events. Whilst it is important to allocate spaces for event patrons, a certain percentage of parking must be reserved for in-house guests and other patrons.

Where parking may be a problem, arrangements may need to be made with local car park facilities, whether to arrange special prices or to reserve spaces, so that some form of alternatives can be provided to function patrons or in-house guests.



Adequate notification

Regardless of the activity that may impact on other customers and in-house guests, generally, with the provision of some advanced notice, they may be more accepting of the impacts as it will not be a surprise and they will have time to make suitable arrangements.

Methods of suitable notification may include:

- Signs in the foyer
- Signs in elevators and bathrooms
- Letters sent to guest rooms
- Verbal explanation – at reception or by staff in other departments.

3.5 Arrange for external services as identified

Introduction

Because all functions are unique they demand attention be paid to identifying and organising necessary resource requirements for every function or event.

While the venue will have certain physical facilities available as standard, individual functions traditionally may require the use of specialised skills or equipment which may not be available within the organisation.

At these times, external services will be utilised.

Given the nature of the function department, function managers will have strong working relationships with a number of external suppliers to help meet the requests of clients.

Types of external providers

Many functions will require you to use the services of third party, external businesses to source items and services needed to ensure the successful running of a function.

These external suppliers can vary enormously depending on the type and scale of the function and may include:

- Florists
- Photographers
- Party Hire companies – for trestles, extra crockery, cutlery, glassware, chair covers, seating, decorations
- Entertainers – bands, disc jockeys, solo performers etc.
- Suppliers of rental technical equipment for audio and visual needs
- Printers – for personalised stationary, menus, signage and decoration needs
- Security agencies – for extra security staff
- Employment agencies – for additional waiting, bar, service and cooking staff
- Business support services – such as interpreters, translators, secretarial support
- Transportation – including chauffeurs, limousines, private cars or buses for tours
- Clowns and animals.



Arranging external services

When developing relationships with external providers, there are a number of steps that may be taken including:

Sourcing option

Like with any business, different companies will offer different products and services as a means of identifying their point of difference. Even in similar businesses, such as equipment, linen or theme hire companies, the actual products they provide will differ.

It is a good idea to source at least three companies in a similar field to ensure that you have an understanding of a wide selection of what is available.

Liaising with providers to identify and cost necessary items and services

Given that a hotel's relationship with external suppliers will not be a one-off event, it is important to gain an understanding of what an external provider can provide including:

- Range of offering – selection of products and services
- Pricing structure for each item – including discounts or complimentary additional items
- Service guarantees – what quality and quantity guarantees they can provide
- Availability - how available items are. It is no use choosing a provider, no matter how cheap, if their items are never available
- Pre-event services – delivery and setting up arrangements
- Event services – what will the company do during the event to ensure its products or services operate as expected
- Post-event services – take down and removal of items, cleaning etc.
- Billing and payment arrangements.



In the eyes of the customer, what is provided at an event, regardless of whether internally or externally provided, will impact on the reputation of the hotel. Therefore it is essential that external providers are carefully selected.

Facilitating access by external providers to venue to enable on-site assessment of requirements, facilities and demands

Most external providers will need access to a venue before the commencement time of an event to set up. Likewise after the completion of a function, they will also need time to take down, remove and clean the area.

It is essential that providers understand:

- What time they have access
- Delivery and parking zones
- Storage areas
- Commencement and finishing times of the function
- Amount of time allocated after the event for access.

Connecting service providers with customer, where appropriate

In many cases functions staff will suggest that external providers correspond directly with the client because:

- Functions staff do not have the technical knowledge or understanding of what the external provider can offer
- External providers can explain what they can offer and provide suggestions
- This can remove a level of activity or responsibility from the functions department.

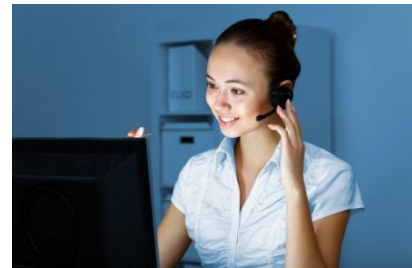
3.6 Purchase necessary stock for function

Introduction

Stock is a very important aspect of a function and without it no function can take place. Many functions require a wide variety of stock items which need to be arranged, whether borrowed from other departments, ordered internally through the purchasing department, purchased or hired through external providers.

Regardless of how stock is arranged it is essential that the:

- Right stock is available
- In the right amount
- In the right condition
- At the right time.



Types of stock

This stock reflects the agreed client requirements and may include, but is certainly not limited to:

- Food and beverages to match identified menu selections
- Decorations including flowers, table decorations and displays, stage decorations, dance floors, bunting and other decorations as requested by customer
- Stationery such as meeting note pads, pens, folders, pencils, whiteboard markers, butcher's paper, name card holder, name tags etc.
- Equipment – data projectors, whiteboards, DVD players, AV equipment etc. These items are normally hired as opposed to purchased
- Linen – table covers, chair covers, napkins, skirting etc
- Crockery and glassware
- Cleaning supplies such as cleaning chemicals (all-purpose cleaners, abrasive cleaners, deodorisers, window cleaners, carpet spot cleaner) and cleaning equipment (cleaning gloves, mops and buckets and machines such as vacuum cleaners, polishers etc)
- Consumables such as toilet paper, rubbish bin liners, soap for use in public toilets, light globes, tissues, paper towels and so on.

Ordering and purchasing stock

On most occasions stock will have to be purchased to meet specific needs of a proposed function.

The procedure to purchase special stock (that is, stock not normally used by the venue) may vary from establishment to establishment and can require special authorisation prior to purchase.

You must become familiar with all costs associated with employing the services of an external supplier, costs that must usually be approved by the client and must certainly be factored in to the final price of the function.

Ordering internally

Larger venues tend to focus their purchasing through a Purchasing Officer.

Where a Purchasing Officer is used, departments – via their department heads – forward their stock requirements to the Purchasing Office, and it is up to this person to identify the best deal, and purchase the stock required.

Communication between department heads and the Purchasing Officer will usually occur on a form ('Request for Stock', or even a 'Requisition'). Some establishments use in-house e-mails.

Ordering externally

Where purchases are not centred through one person, it is common for department heads to order stock for their departments. The stock they are authorised to order is usually limited by a dollar amount, meaning that without specific approval, their purchases for a given period must never exceed the level set by management.

This method of purchasing allows those 'on the ground' to make the purchasing decisions they see fit. They are able to react quickly to customer demand and are able to capitalise on special deals, etc. This system also enables management to retain control of the total amount of stock on hand.

People, such as function managers, who may have the authority to purchase items, must be aware of:

- Dollar limits that apply
- Terms of trade
- Preferred suppliers
- Preferred in-house delivery requirements
- Full establishment details to facilitate making the purchase. This may include your Customer/Identification Number, and your postal address
- Documentation (such as Purchase Order) needed to support a purchase
- Signatures or authorisations required.



Purchase orders

To purchase a service or goods from an external supplier, whether arranged directly or through internal channels, in most cases you will be required to complete a purchase order form.

The information required to complete a purchase order form might include any of the following:

- Purchase order number
- Supplier's name, address, telephone number
- Date of order
- Description of the item and quantity required
- Unit and total price for the hire/purchase
- Date and place of delivery of the items/services
- Payment terms and conditions
- Name, department and signature of person placing the order
- Reason for the order – for example 'Smith and West Function on 10th September'. This helps track the cost and ensure it is charged against the correct function.

Delivery of stock

All incoming stock must be checked against purchase and supply agreements, in all necessary details.

Basically, this check is done when the goods are delivered and, in theory, before you sign for them. In practice, in the hectic activity of a large delivery area, many deliveries are signed for without any checking being done.

The checks are then done as soon as possible after accepting the delivery and any discrepancies notified to the suppliers as soon as possible.

Most suppliers are happy with this arrangement. The last thing they want is for their delivery drivers to be tied up while you finish checking two or three orders that are in front of their order.

This is another example of the informal nature of ordering and delivery. It is built on trust, common sense, and goodwill and generally it works pretty well.

Checking deliveries

When checking a delivery, your aim is to:

- Make sure all items ordered have been supplied, as requested
- Confirm all items listed on the paperwork accompanying the delivery have in fact been delivered
- Ensure all items delivered are in good condition
- Ensure items are of the correct size
- Ensure items are of the correct quality
- Ensure the correct price has been charged.



Items that have not been delivered, due to the supplier not having them in stock, should be listed on the accompanying paperwork as 'Outstanding'.

Items that are short-delivered must be followed up and an appropriate Credit Note raised by the supplier where appropriate.

Date of delivery

Stock, regardless of whether it has been purchased or hired should always be brought into store at least two days before the date of the function, where possible or convenient. This allows for alternative arrangements to be made where non-supply occurs.

Naturally larger items such as equipment or theming, or delicate items such as flowers, may only need to be delivered on the day of the function.



3.7 Prepare Running Sheet for function

Introduction

In section 3.1 the concept of the Function Sheet was detailed, which was a summary of the key points of a function.

This section will look at the concept of the 'Running Sheet'. This is another important document that identifies the schedule and timing aspects of a function.

Prepare Running Sheet

Along with a copy of the function sheet, it may be house policy to present the client with a running sheet (see below) for their function which can be discussed and used to confirm details or identify situations where you have misunderstood or misinterpreted the client's needs.

Timing details and appropriate coordination of activities are a very important aspect of running a function or an event. Determining the appropriate times for the different stages of the function will ensure food and beverage service, technical arrangements and other service provisions can be timed and coordinated to coincide with the client's timing requirements.

Proper coordination for events ensures that multiple activities in a variety of locations can occur at the same time.

These timing details should be recorded on a 'running sheet'.

For example:

Guest arrival	6:30PM
Pre-dinner drinks	6:45PM
Seated for dinner	7:15PM
Entree	7:20PM
Speech and presentation	7:45PM
Main course	8:15PM
Entertainment	9:00PM
Dessert/coffee	9:30PM
Departure	10:30PM

Naturally the larger the function and the more activities and inclusions there are, the bigger and more complex this sheet will be. Computerised event management software may be used to facilitate this, enabling easier control over multiple functions and at multiple locations.

A running sheet will also be distributed to other departments and used by them in their contribution to the function.

Examples of how this may be used can include:

- Staff setting up the rooms need to know when they must have everything ready
- Technical staff need to know the time when equipment will be needed, and for how long
- Kitchen staff need to know when food (each course, including pre-dinner snacks as well as all morning and afternoon teas) is required for service
- Beverage staff need to know which beverages are to be served, and when
- Service staff need to be informed of service times, so they know when to prepare, serve, clear, clean, re-set, etc.

Disseminating and explaining Running Sheet to colleagues and staff

Not only is it important that all relevant personnel have received a copy of the Running Sheet, but it is vital that they understand:

- Their role in the function
- How their role needs to interact with others.

The best way to ensure that all departments and staff associated with a function are united and working as a coherent unit is to conduct a staff briefing sessions. This will be explained in more detail in the next section.



3.8 Conduct pre-function briefings

Introduction

Communication and planning is the key to success in any operation. This is especially true in functions where two events are never the same and therefore staff must be aware of the requirements for each and every new function.

The best way to communicate to staff the requirements of an event is in the form of a pre-function briefing when staff are all together.

Naturally department heads and external providers may have held various meetings in the lead up to an event. However, staff who will actually be performing the bulk of the activities were normally not present at these, and therefore would be unaware of what the upcoming function entails.

Persons involved in briefing

Before the function is conducted it is traditional to conduct a briefing.

This briefing may involve:

- Heads of Departments – Food and Beverage, Kitchen, Front Office, Housekeeping
- Waiting staff
- Beverage staff
- Security staff
- Storeroom staff
- Technical staff
- Third party suppliers who are responsible for products and services to be supplied or who have key roles such as sound and lighting, special effects and activities
- The client or their representatives. In some cases it can also be useful to invite the client to the briefing to enable them to speak first-hand to all those involved.

Contents of a briefing

Before functions commence, the event coordinator should brief the relevant departments and all operational staff about the full and final details so as to ensure the smooth running of the function.

This briefing should be made to all staff involved. In reality this rarely occurs due to the casual nature of many of the staff who are used.

The briefing should cover any relevant information and important points about the function and include distribution of the latest running sheet to staff.

The briefing should address:

- Identifying customer and attendees to staff
- Overview of the function covering:
 - Who will be there – including identification of any celebrities, ‘stars’, media and other VIPs
 - Overall provision of food, beverages, facilities and services, as agreed with the client and attendees
 - Type of function
 - Identification of all rooms
 - Explanation of all activities
 - Final numbers
- Describing anticipated or planned function including distribution of Running Sheets and discussing the importance of timing requirements
- Last minute changes to the running sheet
- Special requests made by the client and how they are going to be handled
- Particular issues the venue expects with certain aspects of the function such as where problems, equipment shortages, tight timelines and other issues have been identified
- Identifying options that exist for service recovery where service timing points are exceeded
- Presentation of service standards and mention of any security issues
- Clarification of ‘chain of command’ for all staff including specific scopes of authority, as they may apply
- Arrangements for security, media access, meals, photo/filming opportunities and passes
- Specific ‘Do’s and Don’ts for the function. These should always be mentioned even where staff are familiar with venue protocols in this regard. Basics include:
 - No staring or pointing at celebrities
 - No asking for autographs or photographs
- Allocating roles and responsibilities
- Allocation of specific duties to specific staff which should address set-up, implementation and take down stages of the function
- Allocating stations to waiting staff and explaining seating plan
- Any last minute changes of any aspect of the function. This frequently involves finishing time and arrangements relating to liquor provision
- Checking uniforms and personal presentation of staff
- Completing time sheets
- Discussing when staff breaks will be taken during the event.



3.9 Finalise function details with customer, colleagues and staff

Introduction

Now that the function is just around the corner, it is essential that any outstanding details are confirmed with the client and communicated to all relevant stakeholders.

Finalise function details

Finalising function details may include:

- Meeting with the customer to run through the Running Sheet to ensure that both parties are on the right page and to ensure that there are no obvious differences of opinion or thoughts on the event. Now is the time for any elements of the function that the organisation has not taken into account to be addressed by the client
- Accommodating last-minute changes as requested by customer, where possible. This may not always be possible, especially if they have been made at the last minute, but the organisation should try to make every effort to do so
- Obtaining additional deposit, if applicable
- Confirming amended details as set out in Function Sheet.

Prepare, update and distribute event documentation to clients, relevant colleagues and suppliers

As mentioned, communication is extremely important in relation to all functions, especially in the final lead up to the function. It is important that everyone understands all final details in relation to a function.

Normally this will come in the form of the final Running Sheet which must be distributed to all relevant parties in a timely manner.

Methods of distribution of the final Running Sheet may include:

- Function coordinator distributes personally to all those involved
- Posting on departmental notice boards
- Giving multiple copies to departmental heads for them to distribute to staff
- Email
- Phoning – especially external suppliers.

3.10 Monitor set-up for the function

Introduction

It is critical to have the function set up and ready to go by the agreed starting time. Any function that is not ready when required is destined to failure. You seem never able to retrieve a situation where you begin behind time.

A key objective when monitoring set up for a function is that all necessary mise-en-place is completed.

Mise-en-place

What does *mise-en-place* mean?

Mise-en-place is a French term that means 'to put in place'.

The term traditionally was used in kitchens to describe the activities required prior to commencing food preparation of a dish, such as assembling the ingredients and equipment needed, pre-heating the oven etc. It is now a common term used in all food and beverage outlets including dining rooms, restaurants and functions.



Therefore, 'set up and mise-en-place' refers to all the activities required to prepare the room for service. It means setting the tables and putting everything that is needed where it should be and in the quantities required to support the function.

Set up policies and procedures

What enterprise procedures and requirements may apply?

These can address:

Adhering to establishment Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) that may relate to:

- Following prescribed safety procedures including the use of all safety equipment and clothing that is provided
- Adhering to safe food handling practices as set out in the Food Safety Plan/Program for the premises
- Staying within allocated scopes of responsibility
- Discharging all tasks to the best of your ability
- Ensuring that all allocated tasks have been completed as described by your Position Description or Jobs Checklist
- Notifying management when a problem, hazard or other situation likely to impact on service delivery is identified
- Working only the allocated hours as stated on the roster unless specific and written approval for overtime is obtained.

Using checklists

When preparing activities for functions, there no doubt there will be many small tasks that need to be performed. As will be explained later in this section, some activities to be completed will relate specifically to a particular function, whilst others will be common to all functions.

Regardless of the variety or list of activities to be performed, there must be a method of ensuring that all important activities are not only completed, but can easily be monitored to ensure they have been completed.

One effective method to ensure activities can be monitored is through the use of checklists.



Importance of Checklists

An industry-wide method of monitoring completion and monitoring of activities is to use a series of checklists.

Not only do checklists help remind staff of what needs to take place, it helps ensure activities are not forgotten. In addition checklists can easily be used by management and staff to see that activities have been completed, by whom and at what time. It therefore makes it an easy to use referencing and monitoring tool.

Many examples of checklists are available but the key to using them is that they must reflect the needs of the premises, whilst still being flexible enough to apply to individual functions.

The use of checklists by staff

Checklists can be posted throughout the work area and used by staff as prompts of what needs to be done.

These checklists must reflect the procedures which have been generated. There must be congruence between these 'official documents' and what staff have been told are the requirements.

These checklists are very helpful in the functions department, as each function will be different and also due to the fact that many staff may be employed on a casual basis and may not be familiar with the exacting standards or procedures that need to be followed.

The use of checklists by supervisors

Supervisors can use checklists to monitor staff activities because they introduce the following into the overall process:

- No aspect of the job is left out of the monitoring process when a comprehensive checklist is used
- Consistency across all staff whose performance is being monitored. All staff are evaluated against the same criteria
- Subjectivity in monitoring. The areas to be checked are dictated by the checklist and not by the whim of the supervisor
- Matters that are regularly occurring as non-compliance issues can be identified and fed back to staff so top-up training can occur in-house.

Developing checklists

Checklists may be developed to monitor procedures being implemented by staff and to monitor the condition of areas as part of scheduled inspections.

Developing a dual-purpose checklist helps save time. You can monitor staff performance at the same time you monitor the condition of the area.

When developing checklists it is important to:

- Ensure all aspects of the process or area are covered – check legislated requirements, in-house practices, house standards and relevant documentation. Personal observation combined with proper industry and site knowledge are key factors
- Talk to those who are performing and supervising the work to ensure nothing important is missed, to ensure the correct workplace sequence is adhered to and to factor in specific workplace techniques, problems and issues
- Trial a draft checklist to see if it is satisfactory, appropriate and comprehensive before full implementation of the checklist occurs.

Example of checklist

On the following page is an example of a checklist that can be used in the functions department to help staff prepare for a function.

Functions Job Checklist Checklist usage: Before each session Responsibility: Floor staff Compliance level: All tasks must be completed	
Cleaning and checking the function room	☐
Cleaning and checking the customer facilities – toilets, reception areas, outdoor areas	☐
Setting comfort levels – music, air conditioning, lighting	☐
Preparing function floor plan/table plan	☐
Obtaining the cash register floats – and change	☐
Preparing servicewear, cutlery, crockery and glassware	☐
Setting tables – to match floor plan/table plan and the menu style being used: laying table clothes, setting cutlery and side plates necessary accoutrements to dress the table	☐
Room set up – to conform to standard requirements and function requirements	☐
Preparatory activities – such as folding serviettes, preparing butters, preparing flowers, polishing cutlery	☐
Preparing service equipment – such as ice buckets and stands, espresso machines, waiter's stations, gueridon trolleys, tea making facilities, bain-maries	☐
Liaison between staff	☐

Planning the set-up

Many venues will have plans of previous function set-ups to guide set-ups.

In all instances the room set-up must be in accordance with client wishes as set out in the contract.

Furniture arrangements and layout of the room will depend on the number of guests at the function, and things such as whether or not a dance floor is required, whether some form of display is needed and the other activities included.

A seating plan may need to be provided where sit-down meals are being provided and there can be a need to obtain head table details including number required and names of people sitting on it.



When setting up the relevant locations the function sheet should be referred to in order to determine the need for specific furniture such as display tables, registration tables, tables for merchandise and delegate materials, catering and IT requirements.

A checklist may be prepared prior to set-up and used during the set-up to make sure all requirements are provided as agreed. Where there are multiple rooms, there should be one checklist per room.

Decorations, flower displays, and table settings must likewise be in accord with client wishes and with the requirements of the menu decided on.

Setting-up the room according to instructions

Pre-planning is extremely important to ensure staff costs do not over-run budget during the set-up stage. Staff requirements for functions are often staggered with staff coming on at different times so that staff levels increase closer to function time and taper off after the main event.

Pre-planning must determine what tasks need to be carried out, how long those tasks will take and allocation of staff accordingly. The checklists referred to above will assist in this regard.

During room set-up it is common for client personnel or family to also be there, perhaps setting up a display or assembling some specific item which they have provided. A contact person should be identified for liaison purposes with these people so as to stop them interrupting venue staff, and to increase the chance of positive guest-venue relations.

Additional tasks include:

- Facilitating access to function area by customer to undertake their own decoration
- Facilitating access to function area by external providers to set-up their equipment
- Taking action to address problems arising including bringing in extra staff, re-allocation of duties, and obtaining items identified as necessary at short notice.

Floor-related mise-en-place tasks

Whilst each function may be different, with specific mise-en-place tasks associated with each, as mentioned on the previous page, there will be general activities that need to be followed when setting up for a function that includes food and beverage service.

While the roles of individual staff will vary as designated by the supervisor to reflect the requirements of the function, there nonetheless always remains a non-negotiable requirement to undertake certain tasks.

The following mise-en-place activities must be addressed by food service staff:

- Preparing, polishing and setting glasses on each table at each setting including the equipment to ensure that glassware is available and has been prepared to support the service of special beverages as required for the function
- Preparing crockery and cutlery for placement on tables. Most premises require crockery to be checked to ensure it is clean and free of chips or cracks and that cutlery is to be polished prior to being set
- Checking that items required to support the service of menu items as listed are ready and available. This can include:
 - Platters, lids and covers
 - Service utensils such as spoons and forks for silver service, tongs, cake lifts and stands, sauce boats and underliners
 - Oven-to-table ware. This is commonly the responsibility of kitchen staff but waiting staff may be responsible for ensuring the stands or mats for placement of these hot items are ready and available
- Folding napkins including the preparation of waiter's cloths and napkins ready for use on clothed service plates
- Preparing condiments including refilling, cleaning and placement on tables and in waiter's stations
- Preparing butters including spares to cater for situations where extra butter is required
- Readyng all equipment such as espresso machines, tea and coffee-making equipment, bain maries, waiter's stations
- Checking or preparing display materials. Some properties will feature a display table to fit in with a theme
- Preparing and checking operational readiness of cash registers where a cash service is operating. This can include collecting and counting the float, obtaining change, checking the audit tape is sufficient for the upcoming session, and ensuring the date and time is correct. This may be the role of bar staff in some venues where accounts are processed through the bar register



- Checking that table dressings reflect dining needs, function requirements and house requirements. This may include checking and making necessary adjustments to items such as:
 - Linen presentation – checking the serviette fold used is as required, that napkin folds are uniform, clean and attractive and that overlays have been used as intended
 - Paper overlays and serviettes. Depending on the style or standard of the room, there may be a requirement that paper items are used as opposed to linen ones
 - Placemats – checking cleanliness
 - Glassware – to reflect house policy or function requirements
 - Servicewear and flatware – making sure that necessary quantities of normal servicewear is ready for use, and that special items are available to suit identified guest needs
 - Floral arrangements – checking bud vases for acceptable appearance and to make sure they are in position
 - Condiments – checking they are present, clean and filled
 - Table numbers- where they are used, checking to make sure all tables have numbers that reflect the floor plan and table plan.



Setting the tables

Tables must be set to:

- Reflect the menu that is being used for the function
- Reflect the floor or table plan that has been prepared
- Comply with house and function requirements relating to table dressings, colours of tablecloths, overlays, napkins. It also includes function preferences for things such as placement of wine glasses on the table for each cover or setting
- Ensure uniformity throughout the room. Table set ups should be the same across the room.



Tables and chairs should be checked prior to service to ensure:

- Guest comfort. Tables and chairs that are unstable reduce the level of guest satisfaction, enjoyment and comfort with their service experience
- Guest safety. Checks should ensure the furniture is 'fit for purpose' and does not present a hazard to those using it. Checks should ensure nothing is broken
- Appropriate access so that guests can freely gain access to their seats and move safely throughout the room. Special care and action may need to be taken where wheelchair access is required and where gueridon trolleys are going to be used. In addition there must be adequate room for functions service staff to move in an efficient manner.

Bar related mise-en-place tasks

Miser en place tasks for the bar may include:

- Storing beverages that have been delivered to the bar where stock is waiting to be put away. This is usually the first job to do in order to get drinks that require refrigeration into the fridges as soon as possible. All stock should be rotated using the First In, First Out (FIFO) method meaning that existing stock should be moved forward and the new stock stored behind it
- Preparing bar garnishes. These should include the basic lemon and orange slices and lime quarters as well as more sophisticated garnishes for any cocktails that are being offered as part of the function
- Preparing ice including obtaining ice, crushing ice and readying ice buckets and stands
- Preparing and checking operational readiness of cash registers if a cash bar system is operating
- Checking to see that all beverages listed on running sheets are available and noting those that are not for mention at the staff briefing or ordering replacement stock as required
- Checking the post-mix to make sure it is fully operational for all flavours and the water button, and that it is being delivered at the right temperature and strength
- Turning on espresso coffee machine
- Setting out drip trays with de-naturing agent
- Setting out under-trays and racks for dirty glassware
- Checking equipment and bar utensils are clean and in working order. This check should include all operational bar equipment
- Placing racks of clean glassware out into their service positions. This may be in a glass chiller which will need to be turned on
- Checking glassware to ensure there are no cracks, chips, lipstick marks etc
- Placing spirit pourers on the appropriate bottles ensuring sufficient supply of liquor
- Stacking and ensuring cleanliness of service trays
- Filling up ice buckets
- Opening pre-selected wines
- Preparing and filling water jugs or other items that are to be pre-placed on function tables
- Preparing pre-ordered drinks
- Bar staff may also be required to set out appropriate glassware on the tables and to prepare service trays and drinks for, say, pre-function drinks in the lobby or champagne.



Timing

It needs to be restated that timing is critical to all functions.

Nowhere is this more important than during preparation. A function that gets behind during the set up phase always seems to be playing 'catch up'. This tends to unsettle staff, cause tension and produce a sub-standard function.

For this reason it is vital to monitor preparation and take action where preparation begins to fall behind predicted timelines.

This may mean getting extra staff, either 'borrowing' them from other areas, or hiring more, cutting back on breaks, helping yourself or monitoring staff performance more closely.



You cannot afford to just ignore things when they get behind.

Remember, if the arrangement is that guests arrive at 7:00PM, that's when they'll arrive. They won't turn up 20 minutes late just because your preparation is running 20 minutes late.

3.11 Monitor set-up for the function

Introduction

Not only is it important that activities are monitored in the lead up to a function, it is absolutely essential that they are monitored as the function is taking place.

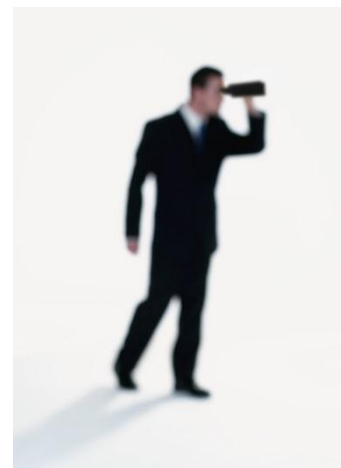
With many functions comprising a number of activities, which often impact on other activities, across a number of job roles and departments, it is important that the manager has a true grasp of what is happening and has the ability to make changes immediately to ensure the smooth conduct of all activities.

This section focuses on monitoring and reviewing of staff activities during a function.

Managers must ensure that work activities designated to staff or which make up their job role, must be completed in an acceptable manner within the desired time frames.

Simply because standards have been developed, put in writing, explained to staff and ratified by management, doesn't mean they will always be implemented.

What is required is some monitoring of customer service in the workplace to ensure standards are met in accordance with organisation policies and procedures.



Monitoring methods

Throughout the function you have to monitor activities and implement the running sheet as agreed with the client, taking into account any factors that may arise which can give cause for changes.

The most important thing in monitoring function activities is the will to monitor them. You have to want to monitor them.

The most common problem is service standards are developed and communicated but not monitored. If service delivery standards are not monitored the result can be that service standards quickly drop and this impacts adversely on the function, not just on one activity, but on all activities influenced or affected by it.

The common monitoring methods are:

- Workplace observation – watching what goes on as it happens, reading customer body language and measuring waiting times
- Talking to staff – to get their impressions and to identify obstacles that will impact on the ability to perform function activities
- Feedback from the function co-ordinator or customers of the function. Constant liaison with the client or their delegated representative is a given in large functions where there are multiple sites and multiple activities.

Monitoring the function

While the function manager will have overall responsibility for the function, there should be one individual at all times who has delegated responsibility for each area, whether a room or location, where any part of the function is being held.

As the function progresses this person should monitor the running sheet to ensure timelines are maintained and also pay attention to the following:

- Checking running times
- Adjusting service delivery to align with Running Sheet
- Arranging changes to the agreed Running Sheet to accommodate the need to do so
- Ensuring quality service delivery
- Ensuring all customer requirements are met
- Responding to queries and requests from clients and guests
- Liaising with customer during function to check level of satisfaction
- Enquiring if customer has additional requirements during service
- Providing additional items as required. This may include tables, chairs, ashtrays, glassware
- Clearing rubbish and used items



- Monitoring security, patron behaviour and ongoing safety
- Observing what is occurring and factoring these observations into action to be taken to keep the function running on time and keep the client satisfied
- Taking action to address service problems. This will be discussed below.

Taking action to address service problems

It is a fact of life there will be problems of some sort at any function.

Even where appropriate planning and preparation has taken place it is still likely there will be problems.

Problems may be caused by equipment failure, shortage of materials, patrons. Many problems relate to timing issues.

Whatever the cause of the problem the best way to achieve an optimal outcome is to:

- Actively monitor all aspects of the function. Listen to what is being said, watch what is happening and compare 'actual' occurrences to the running sheet. The sooner you find out there is a problem, the better
- Communicate with relevant people about what is happening. This includes:
 - Informing client of problems and advising them of options or actions that will be taken in response
 - Telling kitchen and other departments of changes that are necessary to previously made arrangements, times, quantities etc.
 - Obtaining assistance from others to help deal with, resolve or prevent a worsening of the existing problem situation
- Take immediate action. No problem will ever resolve itself. It will only compound and get worse so it is essential you take action or organise others to take action to address the identified problem.



As soon as you notice a problem or a timing issue you have to immediately begin to do something to resolve or address the situation.

A key is to be prepared yourself to jump in and do whatever is needed.

Working quickly is essential.

Using programmed decisions

Most venues who conduct regular functions will have thought through the potential for problems and issues and developed a series of 'programmed responses' to deal with many issues that can crop up when a function is being conducted.

Programmed decisions identify nominated situations and prescribe the action to be taken in response to them.

The programmed decisions should identify:

- Actions to be taken
- Responsibilities for action
- Sequence in which prescribed actions should be taken.

Programmed decisions should be considered for all predictable problems. These may be seen to include:

- Power failure
- Emergency situations including fire, gas leak, bomb threat etc. The Emergency Management Plan, which will include evacuation procedures, must be considered to ensure it is remains relevant and effective when there are large numbers of people at the venue in function circumstances
- Client dissatisfied with delivery of agreed services
- Venue realisation that there is a deficit in the quality of products being provided
- Sub-standard performance by third party provider
- Technical malfunctions of IT and other equipment
- Last minute changes to agreed requirements including activities, timing, food and beverages as requested by client
- Security problems and unacceptable patron behaviour.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 3.1 Research and identify how to maintain and update Function Sheet
 - 3.2. Research and identify what information you may wish to advise colleagues and staff on in relation to a function
 - 3.3. Research and identify considerations when rostering for a function
 - 3.4. Research and identify:
 - Possible impacts on an event
 - Appropriate action that can be taken to address these impacts.
 - 3.5 Research and identify types of external providers that can be used when arranging a function
 - 3.6 Research and identify:
 - Types of stock needed for an item
 - Sources of stock
 - Procedures used to order stock
 - Considerations when receiving stock.
 - 3.7 Research and identify:
 - What information is to be included in a Running Sheet
 - How to explain Running Sheet information to colleagues and staff.
 - 3.8 Research and identify:
 - Persons involved in briefing
 - Contents of a briefing.
 - 3.9 Research and identify:
 - How to finalise function details
 - How to prepare, update and distribute event documentation to clients, relevant colleagues and suppliers.
 - 3.10 Research and identify how to monitor the set-up for the function, including mise-en-place tasks
 - 3.11 Research and identify how to monitor service delivery of function
-

Summary

Prepare for functions

Maintain and update Function Sheet

- Preparing function sheets
- Maintaining and updating Function Sheet
- Keeping accurate records.

Advise colleagues and staff in relation to function

- Liaise with appropriate colleagues and suppliers to facilitate effective planning of event services
- Types of assistance
- Who might be involved?
- What input can these people make?
- Why involve them?
- Obtaining advice from others.

Roster staff for function

- Reasons for having rosters
- Impacts on staffing
- Calculating staff numbers
- Allocating the right mix of staff
- Accessing staff
- Confirming staff
- Calculating staff hours.

Minimise impact of function on normal establishment operation

- Identify and consider possible event impacts and take appropriate action to address these impacts
- Adequate notification.

Arrange for external services as identified

- Types of external providers
- Arranging external services.

Purchase necessary stock for function

- Types of stock
- Ordering and purchasing stock
- Ordering externally
- Purchase orders
- Delivery of stock.

Prepare Running Sheet for function

- Prepare Running Sheet
- Disseminating and explaining Running Sheet to colleagues and staff.

Conduct pre-function briefings

- Persons involved in briefing
- Contents of a briefing.

Finalise function details with customer, colleagues and staff

- Finalise function details
- Prepare, update and distribute event documentation to clients, relevant colleagues and suppliers.

Monitor set-up for the function

- Mise-en-place
- Set up policies and procedures
- Using checklists
- Planning the set-up
- Setting-up the room according to instructions
- Floor-related mise-en-place tasks
- Setting the tables
- Bar related mise-en-place tasks
- Timing.

Monitor service delivery of function

- Monitoring methods
- Monitoring the function
- Taking action to address service problems
- Using programmed decisions.

Element 4: Follow-up after functions

4.1 Obtain feedback from customer

Introduction

It should be standard practice during and after every function to seek feedback that may be used to assist in the planning and implementation of future functions.

This feedback can come from a variety of sources, all of which can provide invaluable suggestions for improvement in future functions.

This process also enables the venue to determine the level of satisfaction of the client with the function and so provides an opportunity for the business to take whatever remedial action might be deemed appropriate.

Client feedback

During the function

An important task is to seek feedback from the client and guests during the course of a function.

They may provide feedback without any prompting, whilst at other times, it will have to be actively sought out by asking questions or by using a function evaluation sheet.

Both positive and negative feedback should be welcomed.

Positive feedback confirms the function is running as expected and expectations are being met.

Negative feedback provides an opportunity to rectify a less than satisfactory situation.

There may also be times when the original function plan may have to be altered to achieve the customer's expectations. Where possible, changes should be made and the client informed of any additional costs associated with the changes.

After the function

After the function it is good industry practice to speak or meet with the client to determine their level of satisfaction and seek feedback.

It is important the venue identifies anything that failed to meet promises or expectations so they can be flagged for extra attention in forthcoming functions.

A pro forma feedback sheet may be used to guide this discussion to ensure vital aspects are not overlooked.



One on one, face to face meetings with the clients are preferred as they enable you to pick up on body language that may signal problems and the nature of this sort of meeting facilitates following up on issues.

Collecting feedback also helps to identify areas of the function that failed to meet customer expectations and trying to explain the reasons behind these problems, whether caused by the organisation, the customers or out of the control of both.

Some establishments may require the function coordinator to seek written feedback from the customer who attended or organised a previous function. A customer feedback form may be used in such instances and may be supplied to the customer at the end of the function, or mailed out after the event.

It is important all issues mentioned by the client are recorded so they can be discussed internally with relevant staff and suitable arrangements made to ensure mistakes are not repeated in future functions and positive aspects are repeated.

The collection of feedback also helps to seek opportunities to provide further function services to customer. This may be to confirm additional function bookings or provide suitable remedies where the customer is disappointed with the service provider.

Staff feedback

Staff feedback is vital, given that they are the people who can provide a firsthand account of how the event went.

Receiving feedback from operational staff is essential and can assist in assessing the overall running of future functions.

Positive feedback reaffirms the current procedures are working well, while negative feedback may indicate current procedures and methods may need to be revised.

Negative feedback should be accepted and addressed and action taken, where and when necessary, to avoid the same situation from recurring.



It is important that staff understand they are free to highlight any aspect of the function they believe warrants attention. They should feel safe their job is not at risk if they mention something that may 'challenge' arrangements that management put in place.

Staff feedback, which can form part of an individual group discussion, will focus on trying to identify:

- What went right and how this can be replicated
- What went wrong and what changes need to be made to correct this in the future
- Any ideas or suggestions for improvement.

This feedback normally is obtained during the debrief process which will be discussed in more detail in Section 4.3 of this manual.

External provider feedback

It is also worth checking with third party suppliers after a function to obtain their feedback. A telephone call should suffice.

Matters which could be addressed include:

- Did they have sufficient information to enable them to provide the goods and services they were contracted to supply?
- What extra information do they need next time to make their involvement more effective?
- What issues did they note as part of the set-up or as part of the implementation of the function? They can often bring a different but valid perspective to the evaluation process
- What suggestions do they have that may assist in the planning and execution of future functions? It should be remembered that suppliers deal with lots of functions at other venues and can be seen as a legitimate source of input.

4.2 Obtain payment for function

Introduction

Once the function has been concluded and all the feedback has been collected by the customer, it is now time for the client to settle the account.

Preparing the account

When preparing the final account for the client it must be detailed according to quoted prices, confirmed final numbers and actual attendance.

Charges for no-shows or reduced numbers must be fully explained, having been initially explained as part of the initial negotiations, and agreed to, by the client.

Charges may include:

- Food and beverage – as per initial agreement, taking into account adjustments ‘on the day’
- Entertainment – bands, artists, personalities
- Venue hire – fees for rooms
- Labour – technical and service staff to set up rooms, activities or operate equipment during the function
- Flowers
- Audio-visual equipment hire
- Printing, photocopying, secretarial services, phone and fax usage
- Ice or margarine carvings, balloons, streamers and other specialised decorations
- Dance floor hire.



Before the account is presented to the client it should be shown to management for their final approval so all charges may be verified and that all monies expended may be recouped.

A copy of the account must then be presented to the correct person. Care must be taken here to ensure that the 'right' person gets the bill.

For example, it would be most inappropriate and embarrassing for the bride and groom to be given the bill, when the parents had organised the wedding and agreed to pay.

A copy of the account should be placed in the function file.

Methods of payment

When the function is booked a credit check may be done to ascertain client ability to pay.

Where the check reveals a doubt about ability to pay then options are to refuse the function or to request total payment in advance.

Many venues require at least part pre-payment of functions to cover food and base labour costs.

Whatever method of payment is decided on it should be set out on the function sheet under the sub-heading 'billing instructions'.

Some venues require the account to be presented on the day at the end of the function for immediate payment in cash, by cheque or credit card. This is obviously a preferable option for the venue but may be difficult or nearly impossible for the client.

In this case the account presentation should be done sensitively so as not to spoil the occasion. Also you need to be aware the client is sometimes hard to find, or difficult to get away from people that they are talking to.

Moreover the host could also be affected by liquor thereby making discussion of final points and matters difficult.

Where an account is posted out it is common for 7 or 14 day payment terms to apply.



Complete administration documentation

It is quite common for the Functions manager to complete a range of documentation at the completion of a function. There is generally an urgency associated with this as the venue will commonly seek to finalise this aspect of the function as soon as possible.

Activities to complete include:

- Collating feedback from the sources identified in the previous section
- Paying out monies to any entertainers or outside suppliers for services rendered
- Receiving final payment of the client's account in accordance with the terms and conditions set out in the function contract
- Signing off staff time sheets and ensuring all hours claimed by staff have been authorised
- Checking the facilities to determine if repairs are need, service is required or if replacement items need to be purchased

- Processing payment and posting payment record on account
- Issuing receipt and 'Thank you' letter to the client
- Completing a feedback form which is often the basis for the staff debriefing (explained in the next section) and to be used as a database for upcoming functions
- Preparing final comments about the function
- Identifying preferences that may be helpful for future functions by the client
- Adding customer comment cards
- Adding photos taken onto a database to be used as a marketing tool
- Finalising all financial documentation including closure of accounts and printing of final accounts and payments
- Storing the account file in an appropriate storage folder or area.

4.3 De-brief staff

Introduction

In the same way that some properties encourage or require supervisors to hold a briefing session with staff at the start of a session, they also encourage a debriefing session to be held at the completion of the session.

Conduct debriefing session

This debriefing is usually an informal gathering of all staff once the closing procedures have been completed.

It usually takes 5 – 10 minutes. Some venues include a knock-off drink as part of this session: some don't.

It must be remembered that while this session is potentially important and useful, most staff are either tired or just want to go home.

The supervisor leads the session focused on:

- Congratulating staff on work that has been well done during service
- Discussing staffing issues including:
 - Staffing levels
 - Rostered start and finish times – including breaks, where applicable
 - Skill levels required or found to be missing
- Suggestions from staff regarding improvements that could be made to the implementation of future functions
- Highlighting and leading discussion on problems and issues that arose with a view to determining what went wrong and how a similar event can be avoided in the future
- Providing the staff with feedback on their perspective of how the session went and providing feedback they have captured from others such as customers, management or other departments
- Discussing feedback received by staff from those who attended

- Reviewing the quality of service delivery provided with a view to identifying changes that could lead to possible improvements in service delivery
- Encouraging staff to identify issues of concern to them including identification of problems they have found with equipment etc., suspicious persons, procedures that are not working effectively
- Discussing patron issues regarding access, behaviour, intoxication, knowledge about the function
- Discussing operation of ancillary services provided as part of the function such as accommodation, parking, participation in activities, access and use of inclusions
- Presenting issues or details of what can be expected in the next session
- Determining staff who will work on future functions
- Thanking staff for their efforts and contribution.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 4.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify how to obtain feedback including:
 - Client feedback
 - Staff feedback
 - External provider feedback.
 - 4.2. Research and identify how to obtain payment for function, including:
 - Preparing the account
 - Methods of payment that are acceptable
 - Types of administration documentation that needs to be completed.
 - 4.3. Research and identify purpose of debriefing staff, including:
 - Content in a debriefing session.
-

Summary

Follow-up after functions

Obtain feedback from customer

- Client feedback
- Staff feedback
- External provider feedback.

Obtain payment for function

- Preparing the account
- Methods of payment
- Complete administration documentation.

Debrief staff

- Conduct debriefing session.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Allen, Judy; 2009 (2nd edition); Event Planning: *The Ultimate Guide to Successful Meetings, Corporate Events, Fundraising Galas, Conferences, Conventions, Incentives and Other Special Events*; Wiley

Arduser, Lora & Brown, Douglas R; 2004 (1st edition); *The Waiter & Waitress and Waitstaff Training Handbook: A Complete Guide to the Proper Steps in Service for Food & Beverage Employees*; Atlantic Publishing Group Inc

Fenich, George; 2011 (3rd edition); *Meetings, Expositions, Events & Conventions: An Introduction to the Industry*; Prentice Hall

Fuller, John; 1980 (1st edition); *Gueridon and Lamp Cookery*; Hutchinson

Golden-Romero, Pat; 2007 (1st edition); *Hotel Convention Sales, Services, and Operations*; Butterworth-Heinemann

Johnston, R and Clark G, 2008 (3rd Edition), *Service Operations Management*. Pearson Education

Kotschevar, Lendal & Luciani, Valentino; 2006 (2nd edition); *Presenting Service: The Ultimate Guide for the Foodservice Professional*; Wiley

Lillicrap, Dennis & Cousins, John; 2010 (1st edition); *Essential Food and Beverage Service: Levels 1 & 2*; Hodder Arnold

Zeithaml, Valarie A; 2009 (1st edition); *Delivering Quality Service*; Free Press

Trainee evaluation sheet

Organise functions

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Organise functions

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Identify function facilities and procedures at the host establishment			
1.1	Explain the role of the Functions Booking book	☐	☐
1.2	Identify the facilities available for functions	☐	☐
1.3	Identify the styles of functions that can be accommodated	☐	☐
1.4	Identify the styles of service available	☐	☐
1.5	Describe the function set-up options available	☐	☐
1.6	Describe the function menus available	☐	☐
1.7	Identify function costs for the customer	☐	☐
1.8	Develop a function kit	☐	☐
1.9	Identify the role of function-related documentation	☐	☐
Element 2: Liaise with function customers			
2.1	Determine customer needs	☐	☐
2.2	Identify date and time of function	☐	☐
2.3	Match establishment resources to identified need for function	☐	☐
2.4	Provide advice and assistance in relation to the function	☐	☐
2.5	Record function requirements as agreed by customer	☐	☐
2.6	Confirm function booking with customer	☐	☐
2.7	Obtain deposit for function	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
Element 3: Prepare for functions			
3.1	Maintain and update Function Sheet	☐	☐
3.2	Advise colleagues and staff in relation to function	☐	☐
3.3	Roster staff for function	☐	☐
3.4	Minimise impact of function on normal establishment operation	☐	☐
3.5	Arrange for external services as identified	☐	☐
3.6	Purchase necessary stock for function	☐	☐
3.7	Prepare Running Sheet for function	☐	☐
3.8	Conduct pre-function briefings	☐	☐
3.9	Finalise function details with customer, colleagues and staff	☐	☐
3.10	Monitor set-up for the function	☐	☐
3.11	Monitor service delivery of function	☐	☐
Element 4: Follow-up after functions			
4.1	Obtain feedback from customer	☐	☐
4.2	Obtain payment for function	☐	☐
4.3	De-brief staff	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

